

Nexus Technologies — Policy Set (Frozen Cleaned Corpus v1.0)

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Nexus Technologies — Company Profile

1. Company Overview

Nexus Technologies Inc. (“Nexus,” “the Company”) is a mid-sized enterprise software company founded in 2013, specializing in cloud-based workflow automation, data integration platforms, and AI-assisted business tools. Nexus serves mid-market and enterprise clients across finance, healthcare, logistics, and retail sectors.

Attribute	Detail
Founded	2013
Headquarters	Austin, Texas, USA
Employees	~2,400 globally
Industry	Enterprise SaaS / Cloud Software
Flagship Product	NexusFlow — a workflow automation and integration platform
Ownership	Privately held, venture-backed (Series D)
Fiscal Year	January – December

2. Mission

“To simplify complexity in enterprise operations by building software that connects people, data, and decisions seamlessly.”

3. Vision

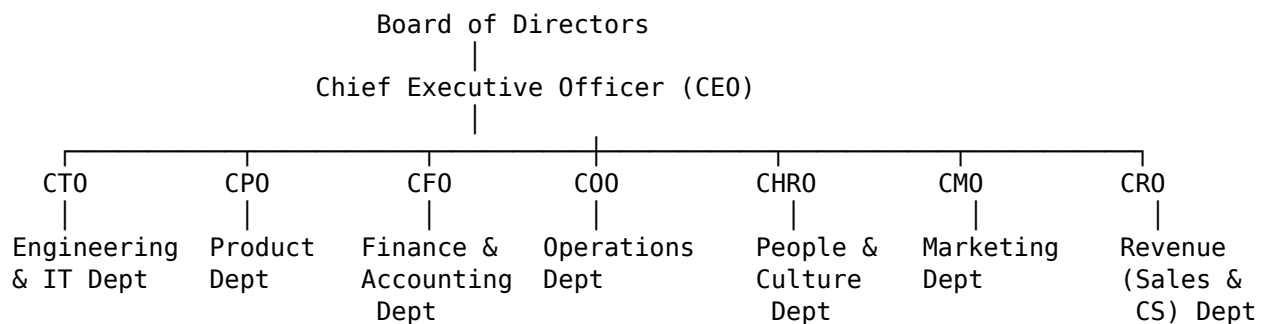
“To become the world’s most trusted platform for intelligent business automation — where every organization, regardless of size, can operate with the efficiency of a digital-native company.”

4. Core Values

Value	Description
Clarity	We communicate simply and design intuitively. Complexity is our problem to absorb, not our customers'.
Integrity	We do the right thing even when no one is watching, especially with data and trust.
Ownership	Every employee acts like a founder of their piece of the mission.
Curiosity	We stay students of our craft and our customers' problems.
Momentum	We favor shipped progress over perfect plans.

5. Organizational Structure

Nexus operates on a **hybrid matrix structure**: functional departments (Engineering, Product, Sales, etc.) report vertically through department leadership, while cross-functional initiatives (“Pods”) are coordinated horizontally through Program Managers.



C-Suite Roles: - **CEO** — Chief Executive Officer - **CTO** — Chief Technology Officer - **CPO** — Chief Product Officer - **CFO** — Chief Financial Officer - **COO** — Chief Operating Officer - **CHRO** — Chief Human Resources Officer - **CMO** — Chief Marketing Officer - **CRO** — Chief Revenue Officer

6. Departments

Department	Function	Led By
Engineering & IT	Product development, platform infrastructure, security, DevOps	CTO
Product	Product strategy, UX/UI, product management	CPO
Finance & Accounting	Budgeting, payroll, procurement, financial reporting	CFO

Department	Function	Led By
Operations	Facilities, vendor management, business continuity	COO
People & Culture (HR)	Recruitment, onboarding, employee relations, L&D	CHRO
Marketing	Brand, demand generation, communications, events	CMO
Revenue (Sales & Customer Success)	New business, account management, renewals, support	CRO
Legal & Compliance	Contracts, regulatory compliance, IP, risk	General Counsel (reports to CEO)

7. Employee Roles (by Department)

Engineering & IT

- VP of Engineering → Engineering Director → Engineering Manager → Tech Lead → Senior/Mid/Junior Software Engineer → QA Engineer → DevOps Engineer → IT Support Specialist

Product

- VP of Product → Group Product Manager → Product Manager → Associate Product Manager → UX/UI Designer → Product Analyst

Finance & Accounting

- VP of Finance → Finance Manager → Senior Accountant → Accountant → Accounts Payable/Receivable Clerk

Operations

- Operations Director → Facilities Manager → Vendor Coordinator → Office Administrator

People & Culture

- HR Director → HR Business Partner → Talent Acquisition Specialist → HR Generalist → L&D Coordinator

Marketing

- Marketing Director → Brand Manager → Content Strategist → Marketing Specialist → Events Coordinator

Revenue (Sales & CS)

- Sales Director → Regional Sales Manager → Account Executive → Sales Development Rep (SDR)

- CS Director → Customer Success Manager (CSM) → Support Engineer → Technical Support Specialist

Legal & Compliance

- General Counsel → Compliance Manager → Legal Counsel → Contracts Administrator

Security (within Engineering & IT)

- **CISO** (Chief Information Security Officer) → Information Security Analysts → Security Engineers. The CISO leads the security function within Engineering & IT and reports to the CTO; the CISO is a functional leadership role, distinct from the eight C-Suite roles listed in §5.

7.1 Leveling Framework (L1-L7)

Nexus uses a single company-wide leveling scale, applied equally to the **IC (Individual Contributor) track** and the **Management track**. Levels map onto the role ladders above (L1-L2 approximate entry/associate roles, L3-L4 approximate Manager/Senior IC roles, L5-L6 approximate Director/Staff roles, L7 approximates VP-level IC or management roles), with the **ELT** (Executive Leadership Team, i.e., the C-Suite collectively, §5) sitting above L7. Compensation, promotion, and expense-policy tiers referenced elsewhere (e.g., corporate card limits, airfare class) use this **L1-L7** scale.

7.2 Squads, Pods, and DRIs

- **Squad** is used interchangeably with **Pod** (§13 Glossary) to describe a cross-functional team assembled around a product initiative or customer segment.
- **DRI (Directly Responsible Individual)** is the single named person accountable for a specific work item, decision, or deliverable at a given time, ensuring nothing is left without an owner. Before extended leave or offboarding, employees complete a **DRI handoff/handover** to a Squad/Pod teammate.

8. Reporting Hierarchy

Standard reporting flows **bottom-up** through direct managers to department VPs/Directors, then to the respective C-Suite executive, then to the CEO, who reports to the **Board of Directors**.

Individual Contributor → Team Lead/Manager → Director/VP → C-Suite Executive → CEO → Board

Cross-functional Pods: For product initiatives, a **Program Manager** coordinates representatives from Engineering, Product, Marketing, and CS. Pod members retain a “dotted line” reporting relationship to the Program Manager while their “solid line” reporting remains within their home department.

9. Approval Hierarchy

9.1 General Principles

- **No self-approval:** the person requesting an approval (a purchase, a promotion, a contract) may never be its sole approver. A second, more senior approver is always required.

- **Escalation by materiality:** approval authority scales with financial, legal, or reputational exposure — larger or riskier decisions require more senior sign-off, per the thresholds in §9.2-§9.5.
- Detailed policy documents (HR, Finance, Legal & Compliance, Security) implement these principles with the specific thresholds and workflows below, and must remain consistent with them.

9.2 Hiring & Promotion Approval

Approval Type	Threshold	Approver(s)
Hiring requisition	Any role	Hiring Manager → HR Director → CHRO
Promotion	Any level	Reporting Manager (sponsor) → Calibration Panel → Director/VP sign-off; VP-and-above promotions escalate to the CHRO

9.3 Purchase, Expense & Procurement Approval

Approval Type	Threshold	Approver(s)
Purchase requisition	Under \$1,000	Direct Manager
Purchase requisition	\$1,000 – \$10,000	Department Director/VP
Purchase requisition	Above \$10,000	CFO + relevant C-Suite sponsor
New vendor/contract	Any	Legal & Compliance review → Department VP → CFO (if financial)
Expense reimbursement	Under \$500	Direct Manager
Expense reimbursement	Above \$500	Direct Manager + Finance

9.4 Document & Policy Sign-off Authority

Document Type	Required Sign-off
Company-wide policy (HR, Legal, Security, IT, Finance manuals)	Executive Leadership Team (ELT — the C-Suite collectively, §5)
Security / compliance policy	CISO + Legal & Compliance (General Counsel)
Customer-facing legal / contract terms	Legal & Compliance (General Counsel) + CFO (or CRO for commercial terms)

9.5 Commercial (Customer) Contract & Other Approvals

Approval Type	Threshold	Approver(s)
Product feature launch	Major release	Product Manager → VP of Product → CPO

Approval Type	Threshold	Approver(s)
PTO / Leave request	Standard	Direct Manager
External public statement/press	Any	Marketing Director → CMO → CEO (if material)
Commercial contract discount	Up to 15%	Sales Manager
Commercial contract discount	15-30%	Regional Sales Director
Commercial contract	Above 30% discount or non-standard terms	VP of Sales + CFO
Enterprise commercial deal	Above \$1M ARR	CRO + CEO

(Detailed policy documents governing these thresholds are issued separately and must remain consistent with this hierarchy.)

10. Office Locations

Location	Type	Notes
Austin, TX (HQ)	Headquarters	Engineering, Product, Executive offices
Denver, CO	Regional Office	Customer Success & Support hub
Lisbon, Portugal	Regional Office	EMEA Engineering & Sales
Bengaluru, India	Regional Office	Engineering & QA hub
Remote-first roles	Distributed	Employees across US/EU/APAC time zones

11. Working Model

Nexus follows a **Hybrid-Flexible Working Model**: - **Hybrid Employees**: 3 days/week in-office (Tue-Thu “Core Collaboration Days”), 2 days remote. - **Remote-First Roles**: Fully remote, with quarterly in-person “Nexus Sync” gatherings at the nearest regional office. - **Core Hours**: 10:00 AM – 3:00 PM (local time zone) for meeting availability. - **Flexible Hours**: Outside core hours, employees manage their own schedule to meet deliverables.

12. Internal Communication Tools

Tool	Purpose
NexusConnect (internal Slack-like tool)	Day-to-day team chat, channels by department/pod
NexusMail	Formal/external email communication
NexusBoard	Project & task tracking (Kanban/Scrum boards)
NexusDocs	Shared documentation, wikis, knowledge base
NexusMeet	Video conferencing

Tool	Purpose
NexusHR Portal	Self-service HR: PTO requests, payroll, benefits
The Signal	Monthly all-hands newsletter/broadcast from Executive team

13. Company Terminology & Glossary

Term	Meaning
Pod	A cross-functional team assembled around a specific product initiative or customer segment
Nexus Sync	Quarterly in-person gathering for remote-first employees
Core Collaboration Days	Tue-Thu, the designated in-office days for hybrid staff
The Signal	Monthly company-wide broadcast/newsletter from leadership
NexusFlow	The company's flagship SaaS product (workflow automation platform)
Flight Plan	Internal term for a quarterly OKR (Objectives & Key Results) document
Solid Line / Dotted Line	Reporting terminology distinguishing primary (solid) managerial reporting from secondary/project-based (dotted) reporting
Launch Gate	The formal review checkpoint before a product feature ships to production
Nexus Way	Informal shorthand referring to the company's cultural norms and values in practice
Home Department	An employee's primary functional department, as distinct from Pod assignments
Beacon Review	Internal term for the annual performance review cycle
Squad	Synonym for Pod — a cross-functional team assembled around a product initiative or customer segment (§7.2)
DRI (Directly Responsible Individual)	The single named person accountable for a specific work item, decision, or deliverable (§7.2)
ELT (Executive Leadership Team)	The C-Suite executives (§5) collectively, as a governance body for company-wide approvals (§9.4)
CISO	Chief Information Security Officer; leads the security function within Engineering & IT, reporting to the CTO (§7)

Term	Meaning
Anchor Days	Synonym for Core Collaboration Days — Tue-Thu, the designated in-office days for hybrid/office-based staff
Nexons	Informal nickname sometimes used in IT/Security documentation to refer to Nexus employees, contractors, and temporary staff collectively

This profile is the canonical foundation document for Nexus Technologies. Future documents (HR policies, security policies, onboarding guides, IT usage policies, etc.) reference these structures, roles, and terminology for consistency.

Nexus Technologies — Glossary

Core Terms

Term	Definition
Nexus	Nexus Technologies Inc., the company described in the Company Profile.
Nexons	Informal internal term for Nexus employees, contractors, and temporary staff.
ELT	Executive Leadership Team, meaning the C-Suite collectively.
DRI	Directly Responsible Individual; the named person accountable for a deliverable or decision.
Squad / Pod	A cross-functional team assembled around a product initiative, customer segment, or business priority.
Core Collaboration Days	Tuesday through Thursday, the default in-office days for hybrid employees.
Core Hours	10:00 AM to 3:00 PM local time, when employees are expected to be reachable.
L1-L7	Company-wide leveling framework used for roles, promotion, compensation, and some travel/card rules.
HRBP	HR Business Partner.
CHRO	Chief Human Resources Officer.
CFO	Chief Financial Officer.
CTO	Chief Technology Officer.
CISO	Chief Information Security Officer.
General Counsel	Leader of Legal & Compliance.
DPO	Data Protection Officer.

Nexus Systems

System	Purpose
Workday	System of record for HR, expenses, procurement requests, vendor data, PTO, and related workflows.
NexusFlow	Nexus flagship workflow automation and integration platform.
NexusDocs	Internal documentation, wiki, and secure document-sharing platform.
NexusConnect	Internal chat and collaboration tool.
NexusMail	Approved email system for official correspondence.
NexusMeet	Video meeting platform.
NexusBoard	IT/software/project request portal used for IT and software requests.
NexusVault	Company-approved password manager.
NexusAuth	Company-approved MFA mobile app.

System	Purpose
NexusSecure VPN	Corporate VPN required for remote access to internal systems.
Nexus Device Management (NDM)	Device management platform enforcing encryption, patches, lock/wipe, and compliance controls.
NexusTravel Portal	Travel booking platform for business travel.
NexusHub	Internal employee portal for company resources and updates.

Data Classification

Tier	Meaning
Tier 1 — Public	Approved for external release.
Tier 2 — Internal	Non-sensitive internal information.
Tier 3 — Confidential	Sensitive business information such as financial forecasts, contracts, source code, employee records, and product roadmaps.
Tier 4 — Restricted	Highly sensitive information such as customer PII, payment data, authentication credentials, and encryption keys.

Nexus Technologies — HR Policy Manual

Document type: HR Policy Manual (Company-Wide Policy of Record) **Owner:** People & Culture (HR) Department — Office of the Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO) **Approved by:** Executive Leadership Team (ELT), per the company-wide policy approval rule in the Company Profile (§9.4) **Applies to:** Nexus Technologies, Inc. and all wholly owned subsidiaries (US, Portugal, India) **System of record:** Workday **Classification:** Internal — All Employees **Version:** 1.0 — July 2026 **Review cycle:** Annual, or earlier if triggered by legal change or major org change

Related documents

This manual is one part of a connected policy set. Where a topic is governed by another document, this manual points to it rather than repeating it:

- **Company Profile** — the canonical source for structure, roles, hierarchy, offices, and terminology. All defined terms below (ELT, Squad, DRI, IC/M track, L1-L7, Core Collaboration Days/anchor days, CHRO, etc.) carry the meaning given there.
 - **Remote Work Policy** — governs remote and hybrid working eligibility, home-office setup, equipment stipends, remote security, and location-based exceptions. **Cross-referenced throughout this manual wherever remote or hybrid work is involved.**
 - **Code of Business Conduct & Ethics** — the detailed ethics standard summarized in §11.
 - **Regional / Local Addenda** — country-specific supplements that adjust this manual where local employment law requires. **Where a local addendum and this manual differ, the local addendum governs for that jurisdiction.**
-

1. Purpose

This manual sets out the human-resources policies that govern employment at Nexus Technologies. Its purpose is to:

- Give every employee a single, clear reference for how core people processes work — from working hours and leave to reviews, promotions, and offboarding.
- Translate the company's **Core Values** (Company Profile §4) into consistent, predictable practices, so people are treated fairly regardless of team, level, or office.
- Establish a shared baseline that applies company-wide, while allowing **Regional Addenda** to meet or exceed the requirements of local law.
- Support managers in applying policy consistently and reduce ambiguity in day-to-day decisions.

This manual reflects the values of **clarity over cleverness** and **default to openness**: it is written to be understood, and it is available to every employee.

This manual is not an employment contract and does not alter the at-will or statutory nature of employment where applicable. Nexus may update these policies; material changes are announced through the sanctioned channels described in §17 and recorded in Workday and the NexusDocs *Nexus Home* space.

2. Scope

This manual applies to **all employees** of Nexus Technologies, Inc. and its subsidiaries, across all six offices and all remote arrangements, unless a section states otherwise.

Group	Coverage
Full-time and part-time employees	Fully covered, with pro-ration where noted (e.g., leave accrual for part-time staff).
Fixed-term / contract employees	Covered for conduct, security, and workplace-behaviour sections; benefit and leave eligibility as stated in their agreement.
Interns and apprentices	Covered for conduct, onboarding, and workplace-behaviour sections; leave and benefits per their program terms.
Independent contractors / agencies / vendors	Not employees. Governed by their commercial agreement, not this manual, though they must follow the Code of Conduct (§11) and security requirements while engaged.

Geographic scope. The manual applies across the Americas, EMEA, and APAC regions. Where local employment law in any jurisdiction (US, Portugal, India) mandates a different or more generous standard, the applicable **Regional Addendum** prevails for that jurisdiction.

Remote and hybrid scope. Employees working under hybrid or fully remote arrangements are fully covered by this manual; the mechanics of *how* remote work operates are governed by the **Remote Work Policy** (cross-referenced in §4, §12, §13, §16, and §17).

3. Employee Categories

Nexus classifies employees to make eligibility for hours, leave, and benefits clear. Category is recorded in Workday and shown on the employment agreement.

3.1 By working time

Category	Definition	Typical eligibility
Full-time	Standard full working week (see §4).	Full leave, benefits, and review cycle.
Part-time	A reduced, agreed weekly schedule below full-time.	Pro-rated leave and eligible benefits based on contracted hours.

3.2 By employment term

Category	Definition
Permanent	Ongoing employment with no fixed end date.
Fixed-term	Employment for a defined period or project, with an end date in the agreement.
Intern / Apprentice	Time-boxed developmental role under a structured program.

3.3 Probationary period

New permanent employees serve a **probationary period of up to three (3) months** (adjusted by Regional Addendum where local law differs). During probation:

- The employee receives structured check-ins at 30, 60, and 90 days (aligned with onboarding, §16).
- Either party may end employment with the notice defined in the employment agreement or local law.
- The employee accrues leave from day one but should coordinate significant time off with their manager.

Successful completion is confirmed in writing by the reporting manager in Workday.

3.4 Employment relationship to the org structure

Every employee has **one functional reporting manager** (the reporting line) and, where applicable, **one delivery lead** through their Squad or Pod (the dotted delivery line), exactly as defined in the Company Profile (§8). HR matters — leave approval, reviews, promotions, and conduct — always run through the **functional reporting line**, never the delivery line.

4. Working Hours

Nexus operates a **hybrid-first model** (Company Profile §11). This section defines standard hours; the **Remote Work Policy** governs where and how those hours may be worked remotely.

4.1 Standard hours

- **Standard working week:** 40 hours, typically Monday–Friday. (Regional Addenda align the working week with local norms — for example, offices in Jordan may observe a Sunday–Thursday week; the applicable addendum governs.)
- **Core collaboration hours:** 10:00–15:00 in each employee’s home-office time zone. Employees are expected to be reachable and available for synchronous collaboration during this window; the remaining hours are flexible around it.
- **Async-by-default:** Consistent with our **Clarity** value (Company Profile §4), decisions and updates are written down first, so distributed teammates across time zones are not blocked on live meetings.

4.2 Anchor days and in-office expectations

- Office-based employees are expected on-site **three days per week**, with **Tuesday–Thursday** as the standard **Core Collaboration Days** (anchor days).
- **Wednesday** is a protected company-wide **focus block** — no internal recurring meetings — to preserve deep-work time.
- Exceptions, fully remote roles, and location-based variations are governed by the **Remote Work Policy**, not this manual.

4.3 Overtime and time recording

- Nexus is an outcomes-driven organization; most professional roles are not measured by clocked hours.

- For roles that are eligible for overtime under local law (recorded in the Regional Addendum), overtime must be approved in advance by the reporting manager and logged in Workday.
- **On-call:** Engineering on-call rotations (PagerDuty) are compensated or time-offset per the Regional Addendum and the Engineering on-call standard. Emergency incident work outside normal hours is followed by adequate rest before the next scheduled shift.

4.4 Rest, breaks, and disconnection

- Employees are entitled to reasonable daily breaks and a proper lunch period.
- Nexus supports a healthy **right to disconnect**: outside core hours, employees are not expected to respond to non-urgent messages. Urgent items follow the incident/escalation channels defined in the Company Profile (§12), not general chat.

5. Annual Leave

5.1 Company baseline entitlement

Nexus provides paid annual leave on a tenure-based scale. The figures below are the **company baseline**; Regional Addenda **meet or exceed** local statutory minimums, and where local law grants more, the higher figure applies.

Completed years of service	Annual leave (full-time)
0 - 2 years	20 working days
3 - 5 years	23 working days
6+ years	25 working days

- Part-time employees receive **pro-rated** leave based on contracted hours.
- Entitlement is **in addition to** public holidays (§8) and sick leave (§6).

5.2 Accrual, carryover, and payout

- Leave **accrues monthly** across the calendar year and is tracked in Workday.
- Employees may **carry over up to 5 unused days** into the next year; carried-over days must be used within the first quarter (by 31 March) or they lapse, unless local law requires otherwise.
- On leaving the company, accrued-but-unused statutory leave is paid out per local law and the Regional Addendum (see §18, Offboarding).

5.3 Requesting leave

- Requests are submitted in **Workday** and approved by the reporting manager.
- Submit routine requests with reasonable notice: **at least 2 weeks** for 3+ consecutive days, longer for extended leave.
- Managers approve based on team coverage and the delivery calendar. Where a request is declined for coverage reasons, the manager proposes an alternative window.
- **Squad coverage:** before extended leave, the employee confirms a **DRI handoff** so no work item is left without an owner (Company Profile §7.2).

5.4 Remote and location considerations

Working remotely from a location other than the employee's registered work location is **not** annual leave, but it may have tax, security, and legal implications. Such "work-from-anywhere" arrangements are governed by the **Remote Work Policy**, not by taking annual leave.

6. Sick Leave

6.1 Entitlement

- Nexus provides **paid sick leave** for genuine illness or injury, with a company baseline of **up to 10 paid sick days per year**, separate from annual leave. Regional Addenda adjust this to meet or exceed local statutory sick-pay requirements.
- Sick leave is **not** to be used as additional annual leave and does not accrue for payout.

6.2 Notification and documentation

- Notify your manager **as early as possible** on the first day of absence — ideally before core hours — via NexusConnect or the method agreed with your manager, and log the absence in Workday.
- For absences of **3 or more consecutive working days**, a medical certificate may be required (per Regional Addendum).
- For longer or recurring illness, the People team coordinates with the employee on medical leave, accommodations, and any statutory long-term sick provisions.

6.3 Working while unwell / remote sick days

- Employees who are unwell should rest and recover, not work through illness. A sick day is a sick day, whether the employee is office-based or remote.
- Nexus does **not** expect remote employees to "work from home because they're only a little sick." If you are unfit to work, record sick leave. Home-working arrangements otherwise follow the **Remote Work Policy**.

6.4 Related leave types

- **Mental health & wellbeing:** sick leave explicitly covers mental-health needs. Confidential support is available through the Employee Assistance Program (\$14).
 - **Caregiver / family emergency leave:** short-notice leave to care for a dependent is available per the Regional Addendum; coordinate with your manager and People.
 - **Bereavement leave:** paid compassionate leave is provided for the death of a close family member (duration per Regional Addendum).
-

7. Maternity, Paternity & Parental Leave

Nexus supports employees becoming parents through birth, adoption, or surrogacy. The company uses a **caregiver-based framework** so entitlements are inclusive of all parents, alongside statutory maternity/paternity provisions.

7.1 Company baseline

Role	Company baseline paid leave
Primary caregiver (the parent taking main responsibility after birth/placement)	16 weeks fully paid
Secondary caregiver	6 weeks fully paid

- These are **company baselines**. Where local statutory maternity, paternity, or parental leave is **more generous**, the statutory entitlement applies — employees receive the **better** of the two, never less.
- Adoption and surrogacy are treated the same as birth for the purposes of caregiver leave.
- Leave may be taken flexibly within the window allowed by the Regional Addendum (e.g., a phased return).

7.2 Continuity and return

- **Job protection:** an employee returning from parental leave returns to the same role, or a comparable one at the same level and pay.
- **Benefits continuity:** benefits (§14) continue during paid parental leave.
- **Reviews and promotion:** time on parental leave does not count against an employee in performance reviews (§9) or promotion timing (§10). Goals and cycles are adjusted pro-rata.
- **Phased return / flexibility:** returning parents may arrange a temporary adjusted or remote schedule. Any remote component is governed by the **Remote Work Policy**.

7.3 Related provisions

- **Pregnancy accommodations** (e.g., adjusted duties, additional breaks) are provided as needed.
- **Pregnancy loss:** compassionate paid leave is available; coordinate confidentially with People.
- **Fertility, family-forming, and lactation support** are described in the Benefits section (§14) and Regional Addenda.

8. Public Holidays

- Public holidays are observed **according to each employee's office location and legal entity**, not a single global calendar. An employee in Austin, Denver, Lisbon, or Bengaluru observes the holidays of that location.
- The official holiday calendar for each office is published annually in Workday and the NexusDocs *Nexus Home* space.
- Public holidays are **paid** and are **separate** from annual leave (§5).

8.1 Working on a public holiday

- Employees are not normally required to work on a public holiday. Where operational coverage (e.g., on-call, customer-critical support) requires it, the employee receives **time off in lieu** or holiday pay per the Regional Addendum.

8.2 Cross-region collaboration

- Because holidays differ by office, teammates should check the shared holiday calendar before scheduling cross-office deadlines or meetings. This is an extension of the async-

by-default norm (§4.1): don't assume everyone is working the same days.

8.3 Floating / flexible holidays

- In addition to fixed public holidays, employees receive **2 floating personal days** per year to observe a religious, cultural, or personal occasion of their choosing. Floating days are requested in Workday like annual leave and do not carry over.

9. Performance Reviews

Performance management at Nexus is continuous, values-based, and consistent across both career tracks.

9.1 Framework

- Reviews assess **what** an employee delivered (impact and outcomes) and **how** they delivered it (alignment with the five Core Values, Company Profile §4).
- The **L1-L7 leveling framework** (Company Profile §7) defines the expectations at each level, applied equally to the **IC track** and the **Management track**.
- Reviews run through the **functional reporting manager**, with structured input from the employee's **Squad/Pod delivery lead** and peers.

9.2 Cycle

Event	Timing	Purpose
Goal-setting	Start of each half	Employee and manager agree on outcomes tied to team/Squad objectives.
Ongoing 1:1s	Weekly / biweekly	Continuous feedback, coaching, and course-correction — no surprises at review time.
Mid-year check-in	Mid fiscal year	Lightweight progress review and goal adjustment.
Annual review	End of fiscal year	Formal written review, rating, and development plan.

Reviews are aligned to the **Quarterly Business Review (QBR)** rhythm at the pillar level (Company Profile §13.4) so individual goals ladder up to company goals.

9.3 Ratings and calibration

- Reviews produce a **rating** on a defined scale (e.g., *Below Expectations* → *Meets* → *Exceeds* → *Outstanding*), covering both impact and values.
- Ratings are **calibrated** across each department by managers and Directors to ensure consistency and reduce individual-manager bias. People (HR) facilitates calibration.
- Ratings inform compensation, development planning, and promotion readiness (§10).

9.4 Feedback principles

- Feedback is **direct but respectful** (Core Value 6 and Company Profile §8 professional-behaviour standards): specific, actionable, and focused on the work, not the person.
- **360° input** (peers, delivery leads, and where relevant, cross-functional partners) is gathered for senior levels.

9.5 Underperformance

- Underperformance is addressed early and supportively through a documented **Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)** with clear objectives, support, and a defined review period.
- A PIP is a genuine opportunity to succeed, not a formality. People (HR) partners with the manager throughout. Outcomes and any consequences follow the Regional Addendum and local law.

9.6 Remote employees

- Remote and hybrid employees are reviewed on the **same standards and outcomes** as office-based peers. Physical presence is never a performance criterion; the **Remote Work Policy** reinforces that evaluation is outcome-based.
-

10. Promotions

Promotions recognize sustained performance at the **next** level — not merely tenure or strong performance at the current level.

10.1 Principles

- **Track-neutral:** the IC track and Management track are treated as equal in seniority and compensation at each level (Company Profile §7). Promotion on the IC track is valued as highly as moving into management.
- **Evidence-based:** promotion is based on demonstrated, sustained impact at the target level against the L1–L7 expectations — shown, not asserted.
- **No self-approval:** consistent with the company’s approval principle (Company Profile §9), no manager promotes their own report unilaterally; promotions go through a review panel.

10.2 Process

1. **Nomination.** The reporting manager (the sponsor) nominates the employee, or an employee raises interest with their manager, during a promotion cycle.
2. **Promotion packet.** The manager and employee assemble evidence: impact examples, peer/stakeholder input, and mapping to the target level’s expectations.
3. **Calibration panel.** A cross-team panel of managers and Directors reviews packets together to ensure a consistent bar across the department.
4. **Approval.** Promotions follow the approval hierarchy consistent with the Company Profile (§9.2): Director and VP sign-off, with People (HR) validating leveling and compensation; VP-and-above promotions escalate per that framework.
5. **Communication.** Approved promotions are recorded in Workday, reflected in compensation, and announced through the appropriate channel.

10.3 Cadence

- Promotion cycles run **twice per fiscal year**, aligned with the review calendar (§9). Off-cycle promotions are possible only in exceptional cases (e.g., a role scope change) and require the same approvals.

10.4 Fairness safeguards

- Calibration panels and People (HR) monitor promotion outcomes for consistency and equity across demographics, offices, and remote vs. office-based employees.
- Time on protected leave (e.g., parental leave, §7) never disadvantages promotion timing.

11. Code of Conduct

This section summarizes the standard; the full detail lives in the **Code of Business Conduct & Ethics**. All employees, contractors, and interns are bound by it.

11.1 Foundations

Conduct at Nexus is grounded in the Core Values (Company Profile §4), especially **Ownership**, **Integrity**, and **Clarity**. Employees are expected to:

- Act with **honesty and integrity** in all dealings, internally and with customers, partners, and regulators.
- **Comply with the law** in every jurisdiction where Nexus operates.
- **Own their decisions** and raise concerns early rather than concealing problems.

11.2 Core obligations

Area	Expectation
Conflicts of interest	Disclose any personal, financial, or family interest that could conflict with your role or Nexus's interests. When in doubt, disclose.
Confidentiality	Protect Nexus, customer, and colleague information. Confidential and customer data may only be accessed on a need-to-know basis.
Data protection & privacy	Handle personal data lawfully and per the privacy standards owned by Legal & Compliance.
Security	Follow the security requirements owned by the CISO/InfoSec team — device security, access controls, phishing vigilance, and incident reporting.
Anti-bribery & corruption	Never offer or accept bribes, kickbacks, or improper gifts. Modest, customary business hospitality is permitted within the gifts standard.
Fair dealing	Compete fairly and honestly; never misrepresent Nexus's products or a competitor's.

Area	Expectation
Company assets	Use company systems, devices, and funds responsibly and primarily for legitimate business purposes.
Accurate records	Keep truthful business, financial, and time records; never falsify data — including demo or evaluation data presented to customers.

11.3 Confidentiality and remote work

- Confidentiality obligations apply **identically** whether working in an office or remotely. Remote employees must protect screens, conversations, and documents from household or public exposure. The specific home-office security requirements (secure networks, device handling, screen privacy) are detailed in the **Remote Work Policy** and the InfoSec standards.

11.4 Reporting concerns

- Employees can raise conduct or ethics concerns to their manager, People (HR), Legal & Compliance, or through a **confidential reporting channel**.
- Nexus prohibits **retaliation** against anyone who raises a concern in good faith (§13.4).

12. Dress Code

Nexus keeps dress code simple and respectful, consistent with **clarity over cleverness** — we care far more about the work than the wardrobe.

12.1 General standard

- The default is **business casual**. Employees should be clean, presentable, and comfortable.
- Teams may set a more casual norm for internal, non-customer days, at the manager's discretion.

12.2 Customer-facing and event days

- When meeting customers on-site, presenting at events, or representing Nexus externally, employees dress **one level up** — **smart business** or as the occasion and customer context require. Sales, Customer Success, and Professional Services teams calibrate to the client.

12.3 Remote video etiquette

- On video calls (**NexusMeet**), remote and hybrid employees follow the **same business-casual standard** as in-office for customer-facing or formal meetings. For internal calls, present a professional appearance and background.
- Remote-specific expectations for background, environment, and virtual meeting conduct are set out in the **Remote Work Policy**.

12.4 Inclusivity

- The dress code is inclusive of religious, cultural, and personal expression, and of reasonable accommodations. It is applied consistently and never used to single out any individual or group.
-

13. Workplace Behaviour

Nexus is committed to a safe, respectful, inclusive workplace — in every office and in every remote channel.

13.1 Respect and professional communication

- Interactions are **direct but respectful** (Company Profile §8). Dismissive or personal language is not acceptable — feedback targets the work, not the person. (“This is wrong” becomes “this breaks on empty input — here’s why.”)
- This standard applies **everywhere**: in person, in NexusConnect, in code reviews, in NexusMeet calls, and in documents.

13.2 Anti-harassment and anti-discrimination

- Nexus has **zero tolerance** for harassment, bullying, or discrimination based on race, ethnicity, national origin, religion, sex, gender identity or expression, sexual orientation, age, disability, marital or family status, or any other characteristic protected by local law.
- This covers all forms — verbal, physical, visual, and digital — and applies to conduct at work, at work events, on business travel, and in company digital spaces.

13.3 Diversity, equity & inclusion

- Consistent with our **Curiosity** value (Company Profile §4), Nexus fosters an inclusive environment where diverse perspectives are actively welcomed. Inclusion is expected of everyone, not delegated to a committee.
- Distributed and remote employees are deliberately included in decisions, information flow, and social connection so that being outside HQ is never a disadvantage — an inclusion principle reinforced by the **Remote Work Policy**.

13.4 Reporting, investigation, and non-retaliation

- Concerns about behaviour can be raised with a manager, People (HR), or the confidential reporting channel.
- Reports are handled **promptly, fairly, and as confidentially as possible**. Investigations follow a consistent process, and both the person raising a concern and the person named are treated fairly.
- **Retaliation** against anyone who reports a concern or participates in an investigation in good faith is itself a serious violation and is prohibited.

13.5 Substance, safety, and workplace conduct

- Employees must not be impaired by alcohol or unlawful substances while working or representing Nexus. Reasonable hospitality at company events is fine in moderation.

- Everyone is responsible for a safe workplace and for reporting safety hazards (in-office) or ergonomic issues (remote — see the Remote Work Policy for home-office setup support).

14. Employee Benefits

Benefits are designed to support health, financial security, growth, and wellbeing. Specific plans, providers, and amounts vary by **office and legal entity** and are detailed in the Regional Addendum and Workday. The categories below are consistent company-wide.

14.1 Health & wellbeing

Benefit	Description
Medical / health coverage	Health insurance or coverage appropriate to each country (or supplementing public healthcare where applicable).
Dental & vision	Provided or available per region.
Employee Assistance Program (EAP)	Confidential counseling and mental-health support for employees and close family, at no cost.
Wellness stipend	An annual allowance toward fitness, wellbeing, or ergonomic needs.
Family-forming support	Support toward fertility, adoption, or surrogacy, per Regional Addendum.

14.2 Financial

Benefit	Description
Retirement / pension	Country-appropriate retirement savings with employer contribution (e.g., 401(k) match in the US, pension schemes elsewhere).
Equity	Eligible employees participate in the company equity program, per their offer and the equity plan.
Life & disability cover	Life insurance and income-protection cover per region.
Referral bonus	A reward for referring a candidate who is hired and stays.

14.3 Time, flexibility & work setup

Benefit	Description
Paid leave	Annual (\$5), sick (\$6), parental (\$7), floating days (\$8.3), bereavement, and compassionate leave.

Benefit	Description
Hybrid flexibility	The hybrid-first model (§4) with flexibility around core hours.
Remote enablement	Home-office equipment and stipend provisions are provided under the Remote Work Policy , not duplicated here.
Learning budget	An annual professional-development allowance (see §15).

14.4 Eligibility

- Full-time employees are eligible for the full benefits package; part-time and fixed-term eligibility is pro-rated or defined by agreement (§3). Benefits continue during paid protected leave (§7).

15. Training & Development

Learning is a core value in practice (**Curiosity**, Company Profile §4), not an afterthought.

15.1 Development framework

- Every employee has a **development plan** created with their manager during goal-setting (§9.2) and revisited each cycle.
- Development is mapped to the **L1-L7 expectations** so growth is concrete and tied to progression (§10).

15.2 Types of learning

Type	Description
Onboarding training	Role, product (NexusFlow), tools, and culture training in the first weeks (§16).
Compliance & security training	Mandatory annual training — including security-awareness training owned by the CISO/InfoSec team , plus privacy and anti-harassment training. Completion is tracked.
Skill & role training	Technical, product, and functional upskilling relevant to the employee's role and growth goals.
Leadership development	Programs for new and experienced managers on the Management track.
Learning budget	An annual allowance for courses, certifications, conferences, or books, approved by the manager within the spending thresholds (Company Profile §9.1).

15.3 Mentorship and knowledge sharing

- New joiners are paired with an **onboarding buddy** (§16).
- Consistent with the anti-silo culture, knowledge is shared through documentation (NexusDocs), internal talks, and pairing. No critical knowledge should live with only one person.

15.4 Equal access

- Remote and office-based employees have **equal access** to training, mentorship, and stretch opportunities. Where training is delivered in person, remote employees are given an equivalent path — a principle reinforced by the **Remote Work Policy**.
-

16. Onboarding

Onboarding gives new employees the tools, context, and relationships to become effective quickly — whether they start in an office or remotely.

16.1 Before day one (pre-boarding)

- People (HR) confirms the offer, paperwork, and start details in Workday.
- **IT & Corporate Systems** provisions accounts and equipment. Access to the sanctioned tools — NexusConnect, NexusDocs, NexusBoard, NexusMeet, and Workday (plus GitHub for source control, as relevant) — is set up per role, following least-privilege access owned by IT and Security.
- For remote or hybrid starters, equipment shipping and home-office setup follow the **Remote Work Policy**.

16.2 First week

- **Welcome & orientation:** company overview (grounded in the Company Profile), values, structure, and how work flows through Squads and DRIs.
- **Manager kickoff:** the reporting manager sets initial expectations and introduces the team and the employee's Squad/Pod.
- **Onboarding buddy:** a peer is assigned to answer everyday questions and help the new joiner navigate norms and channels.
- **Mandatory training:** security-awareness and compliance training (§15.2) are completed in the first week.

16.3 The 30-60-90 plan

Milestone	Focus
First 30 days	Learn the systems, tools, team, and product surfaces; complete required training; make first small contributions.
First 60 days	Take ownership of defined tasks; understand how the role connects to the Squad and to customers.
First 90 days	Operate independently at level; a check-in confirms probation status (§3.3) and sets forward goals.

16.4 Remote onboarding

- Remote onboarding follows the **same milestones**, delivered virtually. Extra care is taken to include remote joiners in team rituals and informal connection. The mechanics (equipment, secure access, virtual first-day logistics) are governed by the **Remote Work Policy**.
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17. Offboarding

Offboarding is handled respectfully, securely, and consistently — whether the departure is voluntary or involuntary.

17.1 Notice

- **Resignation:** employees give the notice stated in their employment agreement or local law (commonly a minimum notice period; managerial roles may require more). Notice is submitted in writing and recorded in Workday.
- **Involuntary exit:** handled with dignity, documented properly, and in line with the Regional Addendum and local law, with People (HR) involved throughout.

17.2 Transition and handover

- Before departure, the leaving employee completes a **DRI handover** (Company Profile §7.2): every owned work item, document, and responsibility is reassigned so nothing is left without an owner.
- Knowledge is documented in NexusDocs per the anti-silo principle.

17.3 Access, assets, and security

- On the last working day, **IT and Security** revoke system access following least-privilege deprovisioning. Access is removed promptly to protect company and customer data.
- Company equipment is returned. For remote employees, equipment return logistics follow the **Remote Work Policy**.
- Confidentiality, IP, and any post-employment obligations from the employment agreement **continue after departure**.

17.4 Final pay and benefits

- Final salary, accrued-but-unused statutory leave (§5.2), and any other amounts owed are settled per local law and the Regional Addendum.
- Information on benefit continuation, equity treatment, and pension/retirement handling is provided by People (HR).

17.5 Exit interview

- Departing employees are offered a **confidential exit interview** with People (HR). Feedback is aggregated to improve the employee experience and is never used to disadvantage the individual.

17.6 Rehire

- Employees who leave in good standing are welcome to be considered for rehire. Records are retained per the data-retention standard owned by Legal & Compliance.
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18. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q1. Do I have to be in the office on Core Collaboration Days (anchor days)? Office-based employees are expected on-site three days a week, with Tuesday-Thursday as Core Collaboration Days/anchor days (§4.2). Wednesday is a company-wide focus block. Fully remote roles and exceptions are governed by the **Remote Work Policy**.

Q2. How do I request annual leave? Submit the request in Workday for your manager's approval, with at least two weeks' notice for 3+ consecutive days. Before extended leave, arrange a DRI handoff so your work has cover (§5.3).

Q3. Can I carry unused annual leave into next year? Up to 5 days, and they must be used by 31 March or they lapse — unless your Regional Addendum grants more (§5.2).

Q4. What do I do on my first sick day? Tell your manager as early as possible (ideally before core hours) and log it in Workday. A medical certificate may be needed for absences of 3+ consecutive days (§6.2).

Q5. Which public holidays do I get? The ones observed at your office/legal entity — Austin, Denver, Lisbon, or Bengaluru. The calendar is in Workday. You also get 2 floating personal days (§8).

Q6. How much parental leave will I get? The company baseline is 16 weeks (primary caregiver) or 6 weeks (secondary caregiver), fully paid — or your local statutory entitlement if it is more generous. You always receive the better of the two (§7.1).

Q7. Is the IC track really equal to management for promotions? Yes. The tracks are equivalent at each level, and IC-track promotions are valued as highly as moving into management (§10.1).

Q8. Are remote employees reviewed differently? No. Reviews are outcome-based, using the same standards for everyone. Physical presence is never a performance criterion (§9.6).

Q9. Where do I report a conduct or harassment concern? To your manager, People (HR), Legal & Compliance, or the confidential reporting channel. Good-faith reports are protected from retaliation (§11.4, §13.4).

Q10. What's the dress code for a customer meeting? Dress one level up from business casual — smart business — calibrated to the customer. On video, the same standard applies for customer-facing calls (§12).

Q11. I'm starting remotely — how do I get my equipment and accounts? IT provisions accounts and ships equipment before day one; the specifics are in the **Remote Work Policy**. Your onboarding buddy and manager help you settle in (§16).

Q12. What happens to my access and equipment when I leave? IT and Security revoke access on your last day, and equipment is returned (remote returns follow the Remote Work Policy). Final pay and any accrued statutory leave are settled per local law (§17).

Q13. Where does this manual not apply? Where a Regional Addendum or local law requires a different or more generous standard — in that case, the local rule governs for that jurisdiction (§2).

Q14. This manual and the Remote Work Policy seem to overlap — which wins? For remote/hybrid mechanics (eligibility, equipment, home-office security, location rules), the **Remote Work Policy** is authoritative. For everything else — leave, reviews, conduct, benefits — this manual governs. They are designed to work together.

This HR Policy Manual is a company-wide policy of record, aligned to the Nexus Technologies Company Profile and intended to be read alongside the Remote Work Policy and applicable Regional Addenda. It will be reviewed annually and updated as the company and its legal obligations evolve.

Nexus Technologies — Information Technology (IT) Policy

Document Owner: IT & Internal Systems (the IT function within the Engineering & IT Department, Company Profile §6) **Approval Authority:** CTO + CHRO (per Approval Hierarchy, Company Profile §9) **Applies To:** All Nexus employees, contractors, and temporary staff (informally, “Nexons” — Company Profile §13) across all office locations and remote work arrangements

1. Purpose & Scope

This policy establishes the standards for the secure and responsible use of Nexus Technologies’ IT resources, including company devices, networks, software, cloud services, and communication tools. It applies to all office-based, Remote-First, and hybrid employees as defined in the Company Profile’s Working Model.

2. Company Devices

2.1 Issuance

- All full-time employees are issued a **Nexus-managed laptop** (standard: MacBook Pro or Dell Latitude, department-dependent) upon onboarding.
- Engineering and IT roles may request additional hardware (external monitors, docking stations) via **NexusBoard** IT Request queue, subject to Manager approval.
- Personal devices used for company work (BYOD) require enrollment in **Nexus Device Management** (see Section 10) before accessing any company system.

2.2 Acceptable Use

- Company devices are intended primarily for business use. Limited, reasonable personal use is permitted provided it does not violate other Nexus policies or introduce security risk.
- Devices must not be shared with family members, roommates, or third parties.
- Lost or stolen devices must be reported to **IT & Internal Systems** within **2 hours** of discovery via the emergency IT hotline or NexusConnect #it-urgent channel.

2.3 Return of Devices

- All company devices must be returned within **5 business days** of separation, as coordinated with the employee’s HRBP and IT.
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3. Password Policy

3.1 Requirements

- Minimum **14 characters**, including at least one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one special character.
- Passwords must not reuse any of the **last 10** previously used passwords.
- Passwords must not contain the employee’s name, username, or “Nexus”/“NexusTech” variants.

3.2 Rotation

- Passwords for **privileged accounts** (admin, finance systems, production infrastructure) must be rotated every **90 days**.
- Standard user account passwords do not require forced rotation but must be changed immediately if compromise is suspected.

3.3 Storage & Sharing

- Passwords must never be shared, written on physical notes, or stored in plaintext files.
 - Approved password manager: **NexusVault** (company-provisioned) is mandatory for all credential storage.
 - Sharing of account credentials between employees is strictly prohibited, including between manager and direct report.
-

4. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

- MFA is **mandatory** for all Nexus systems: NexusMail, NexusConnect, NexusDocs, NexusBoard, NexusFlow, NexusHR Portal, VPN, and all production/cloud environments.
 - Approved MFA methods: **NexusAuth** mobile app (primary), hardware security key (for Engineering/IT privileged accounts), SMS backup (fallback only, not primary).
 - MFA fatigue attacks (repeated push notifications) must be reported immediately to IT Security; employees must never approve an MFA prompt they did not initiate.
 - Loss of MFA device must be reported within **1 hour** to IT & Internal Systems for account recovery via identity verification.
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5. VPN Usage

- All employees connecting to internal Nexus systems (production databases, internal wikis, financial systems) from outside an office location **must** use the **NexusSecure VPN** client.
 - Split-tunneling is disabled by default; all traffic to Nexus internal resources routes through the corporate VPN.
 - VPN access is tied to individual MFA-authenticated accounts; shared or generic VPN logins are not issued.
 - Public Wi-Fi (airports, cafés, hotels) requires VPN activation **before** accessing any Nexus system — no exceptions.
 - VPN sessions auto-disconnect after **30 minutes** of inactivity and require re-authentication.
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6. Software Installation

- Employees may not install unauthorized software on company devices without approval from **IT & Internal Systems**.
- Pre-approved software catalog is available via the **NexusBoard Software Request** portal; most common developer and productivity tools are pre-approved for self-service install.
- Engineering teams may install open-source development dependencies and packages relevant to their work, subject to the **Software Bill of Materials (SBOM)** scan performed automatically by IT security tooling.

- Installation of unlicensed, pirated, or unvetted software is strictly prohibited and may result in disciplinary action.
 - Browser extensions requesting broad data access must be reviewed and approved by IT Security before install.
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7. AI Tools Usage

- Use of AI tools (including generative AI, coding assistants, and chatbots) for work purposes is permitted **only** through the **Nexus-Approved AI Tools List**, maintained by IT & Internal Systems and Legal & Compliance.
 - Approved categories include AI coding assistants, meeting summarization tools, and internal knowledge assistants integrated with **NexusDocs**.
 - **Confidential, customer, or personally identifiable information (PII) must never be entered into public/consumer-facing AI tools** not on the approved list.
 - Employees must not use unapproved AI tools to generate code, contracts, or customer-facing content without human review.
 - Any AI-generated output used in customer deliverables, code, or legal/financial documents must be reviewed and approved by a qualified employee before use.
 - Requests to add new AI tools to the approved list go through **IT & Internal Systems**, with Legal & Compliance sign-off for tools processing customer data.
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8. Email Security

- NexusMail is the only approved channel for official external business correspondence.
 - Employees must not auto-forward NexusMail to personal or third-party email accounts.
 - Suspicious emails (phishing, spoofing, unexpected attachments) must be reported via the **“Report Phishing”** button in NexusMail or forwarded to **security@nexustech.example**.
 - External email senders are automatically flagged with an **“[EXTERNAL]”** banner.
 - Sensitive attachments (contracts, financial data, customer PII) must be encrypted or shared via **NexusDocs** secure links rather than direct attachment where possible.
 - Nexus performs periodic simulated phishing tests; repeated failures may require additional security training.
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9. Internet Usage

- Internet access via Nexus networks/devices is provided primarily for business purposes; reasonable personal use is permitted.
 - Access to categories including gambling, adult content, and known malicious/high-risk domains is blocked by default at the network level.
 - Peer-to-peer file sharing and unauthorized torrenting is prohibited on all Nexus networks and devices.
 - Streaming and high-bandwidth personal use should be limited during Core Hours (10:00 AM–3:00 PM) to preserve network performance for business-critical systems.
 - IT & Internal Systems monitors network traffic for security purposes; usage may be logged in accordance with the (forthcoming) Data Privacy Policy.
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10. Cloud Storage

- Official company data must be stored in approved cloud environments: **NexusDocs** (documents/wikis), **NexusBoard** (project artifacts), and the designated **Nexus Cloud Infrastructure** (engineering/production data).
 - Use of unauthorized personal cloud storage (personal Google Drive, Dropbox, iCloud, etc.) for company data is prohibited.
 - Customer data and PII must only be stored in environments that meet Nexus's data residency and compliance requirements, as designated by Legal & Compliance.
 - File-sharing links from NexusDocs must use the **minimum necessary access level** (view vs. edit) and should have expiration dates set for external shares.
 - Departing employees' cloud storage access is revoked automatically upon offboarding; data ownership transfers to the employee's manager.
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11. Device Management

- All company-owned and BYOD devices accessing Nexus systems must be enrolled in **Nexus Device Management (NDM)**, the company's Mobile Device Management (MDM)/Endpoint Management platform.
 - NDM enforces: disk encryption, minimum OS version compliance, automatic security patching, remote lock/wipe capability, and screen-lock timeout (5 minutes of inactivity).
 - Jailbroken, rooted, or otherwise modified devices are prohibited from enrollment.
 - Lost/stolen devices are remotely wiped by IT & Internal Systems upon confirmed report.
 - Devices failing compliance checks (outdated OS, disabled encryption) are automatically restricted from accessing sensitive systems until remediated.
-

12. Backup Policy

- **Company systems and production data:** Automated backups run daily, with retention of 30 days rolling and monthly archives retained for 12 months, managed by IT & Internal Systems and Engineering.
 - **Employee devices:** Local device backup to Nexus Cloud is automatic and continuous for documents, desktop, and designated folders; employees should not rely on local-only storage for critical work files.
 - **Disaster Recovery:** Critical business systems maintain a Recovery Point Objective (RPO) of 4 hours and Recovery Time Objective (RTO) of 24 hours, tested semi-annually.
 - Employees are responsible for ensuring work-critical files reside in approved cloud/backup-covered locations (Section 10), not solely on local drives.
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13. FAQ

Q: I forgot my NexusVault master password. What do I do? A: Contact IT & Internal Systems via the NexusConnect #it-support channel or NexusBoard IT Request. Identity verification is required before any credential reset.

Q: Can I use my personal laptop to check NexusMail? A: Only if the device is enrolled in Nexus Device Management (NDM) and MFA is active. Unenrolled personal devices cannot access NexusMail or any internal system.

Q: Is ChatGPT or another public AI tool okay to use for drafting client emails? A: Only tools on the Nexus-Approved AI Tools List may be used for work purposes, and no confidential or customer data may be entered into public/consumer AI tools. Check the approved list in NexusDocs before use.

Q: Do I need VPN if I'm working from a Nexus office location? A: No — VPN is required only when connecting from outside an office network (remote work, travel, public Wi-Fi).

Q: What happens if I fail a phishing simulation test? A: You'll receive immediate educational feedback and may be required to complete a short security refresher module. Repeated failures are flagged to your manager and HRBP for additional support.

Q: Can I install Slack, Figma, or other common tools myself? A: Most common productivity and developer tools are pre-approved for self-service install via the NexusBoard Software Request portal. Uncommon or data-access-heavy tools require IT Security review.

Q: What should I do if I lose my company laptop while traveling? A: Report it immediately (within 2 hours) via the IT emergency hotline or NexusConnect #it-urgent. IT will remotely lock and, if necessary, wipe the device via NDM.

Q: Who approves exceptions to this policy? A: Exceptions require written approval from the CTO or a delegated Director of Engineering/IT, in consultation with Legal & Compliance where data handling is involved (per Company Profile §9 Approval Hierarchy).

This IT Policy is a living document maintained by IT & Internal Systems and is subject to periodic review. It should be read in conjunction with the Nexus Technologies Company Profile and future policies including Data Privacy, Acceptable Use, and Security Incident Response.

Nexus Technologies — Information Security Policy

Document Owner: IT & Internal Systems (the IT function within the Engineering & IT Department, Company Profile §6), in partnership with Legal & Compliance **Approval Authority:** CTO + General Counsel + CHRO for policy-wide changes (per Company Profile §9.4 Approval Hierarchy) **Applies To:** All Nexus employees, contractors, and temporary staff (informally, “Nexons” — Company Profile §13) across all office locations and remote work arrangements **Related Document:** This policy should be read alongside the **Nexus Technologies IT Policy**, which governs device management, passwords, MFA, VPN, and software controls referenced throughout this document.

1. Purpose & Scope

This Information Security Policy establishes how Nexus Technologies classifies, protects, and responds to risks affecting company and customer data. Where technical controls are already defined in the **IT Policy** (e.g., MFA, VPN, device management, password requirements), this policy references those controls rather than duplicating them, and focuses instead on data handling, classification, and security behavior expectations.

2. Data Classification

All Nexus data must be classified into one of four tiers. Classification determines handling, storage, and access requirements throughout this policy.

Tier	Description	Examples
Tier 1 — Public	Information approved for external release	Marketing materials, published blog posts, job postings
Tier 2 — Internal	Non-sensitive internal information	Internal newsletters (<i>The Nexus Signal</i>), org charts, internal wiki pages
Tier 3 — Confidential	Sensitive business information	Financial forecasts, contracts, source code, employee records, product roadmaps
Tier 4 — Restricted	Highly sensitive; regulatory or contractual protection required	Customer PII, payment data, health data (where applicable), authentication credentials, encryption keys

- Data owners (typically Directors or above within the relevant department) are responsible for assigning and reviewing classification annually.
 - Default classification for any newly created document with no explicit label is **Tier 3 — Confidential**.
 - Classification labels should be applied in document metadata within **NexusDocs** where supported.
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3. Customer Data Handling

- All customer data is classified **Tier 4 — Restricted** at minimum and handled according to applicable regulatory frameworks (e.g., GDPR, CCPA, HIPAA where relevant to the customer's industry).
 - Customer data may only be stored in Nexus-approved cloud environments as defined in the **IT Policy, Section 10 (Cloud Storage)** — never in personal cloud storage or unmanaged local files.
 - Access to customer data is granted strictly on a **need-to-know basis** and reviewed quarterly by the relevant Director and IT Security.
 - Customer data must never be:
 - Entered into unapproved AI tools (see **IT Policy, Section 7 — AI Tools Usage**)
 - Exported to personal devices or unmanaged USB drives (see Section 7 of this policy)
 - Shared with third parties without Legal & Compliance review and, where applicable, a signed Data Processing Agreement (DPA)
 - Customer data access for support/debugging purposes must be logged and time-limited; standing access to production customer data is prohibited except for designated on-call Engineering/SRE roles.
 - Data retention and deletion timelines are defined per customer contract; Customer Success and Legal & Compliance jointly maintain the deletion schedule.
-

4. Confidential Information

- Confidential information (Tier 3 and Tier 4) includes but is not limited to: unreleased product plans, financial data, employee records, legal contracts, source code, and internal strategy documents.
 - Employees may discuss confidential information only with colleagues who have a legitimate business need, regardless of department or seniority.
 - Confidential information must not be discussed in public spaces (cafés, public transit, conferences) or on personal social media/messaging apps.
 - Employees separating from Nexus retain confidentiality obligations indefinitely for Tier 3/4 information, as outlined in their employment agreement.
 - Sharing confidential information externally requires sign-off per the Approval Hierarchy (Company Profile §9); Legal & Compliance approval is mandatory for any external disclosure of Tier 4 data.
-

5. Access Control

- Access follows the **principle of least privilege**: employees receive access only to the systems and data necessary for their role.
- All system access requires MFA as defined in **IT Policy, Section 4**.
- Access provisioning follows the Reporting Hierarchy (Company Profile §8): new access requests are submitted by the employee's Manager via NexusBoard and approved based on the Approval Hierarchy thresholds.
- **Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)** is enforced across NexusDocs, NexusFlow, NexusBoard, production systems, and financial systems.
- Access reviews:
 - **Quarterly** review of privileged/admin access by IT Security and relevant Directors
 - **Immediate revocation** upon role change or separation, coordinated between HRBP, Manager, and IT & Internal Systems

- Shared accounts are prohibited except for designated service accounts, which require IT Security approval and enhanced logging.
-

6. Phishing

- All Nexus employees complete mandatory phishing awareness training during onboarding and annually thereafter.
 - Suspicious emails must be reported using the “**Report Phishing**” button in NexusMail, consistent with **IT Policy, Section 8 (Email Security)**.
 - Nexus conducts periodic simulated phishing campaigns; results are used for training purposes, not punitive action, except in cases of repeated, uncorrected failure.
 - Employees who suspect they have clicked a malicious link or entered credentials into a phishing site must immediately:
 1. Disconnect from the network (or disable Wi-Fi)
 2. Report to IT Security via the emergency hotline or NexusConnect **#security-incident** channel
 3. Change affected passwords immediately using NexusVault
 - Vishing (voice phishing) and smishing (SMS phishing) attempts should be reported through the same channel; IT Security will never request passwords or MFA codes via phone or text.
-

7. Malware

- All company-managed devices run Nexus-approved endpoint protection software, deployed and monitored via **Nexus Device Management (NDM)** as described in **IT Policy, Section 11**.
 - Employees must not disable, bypass, or attempt to uninstall endpoint security software.
 - Suspicious device behavior (unexpected pop-ups, slow performance, unfamiliar processes) should be reported immediately to IT & Internal Systems.
 - Downloading executable files or macros from unverified or external sources is prohibited without IT Security review.
 - USB devices and external media must be scanned automatically before file access is permitted (see Section 8 below).
 - Suspected malware infections trigger the Incident Reporting process (Section 10) and may result in immediate device isolation from the network.
-

8. USB Devices

- Use of personal or unknown-origin USB drives on Nexus devices is **prohibited by default**.
- Nexus-issued encrypted USB drives may be requested through IT & Internal Systems for specific business needs (e.g., secure offline data transfer) and must be returned or securely wiped after use.
- Any USB device connected to a Nexus device is automatically scanned by endpoint security tooling; unscanned or blocked devices will be denied access at the OS level.
- Tier 4 (Restricted) data must never be transferred via USB device under any circumstance without explicit written approval from IT Security and Legal & Compliance.
- Found or unknown USB devices (e.g., picked up in public, received as promotional gifts) must **never** be plugged into a Nexus device — report to IT Security instead.

9. Encryption

- **Data at rest:** All company devices enforce full-disk encryption via Nexus Device Management (NDM), per IT Policy §11. Production databases and Tier 3/4 data stores use AES-256 encryption at minimum.
 - **Data in transit:** All internal and customer-facing traffic uses TLS 1.2 or higher. VPN connections (per IT Policy §5) are mandatory for remote access to internal systems.
 - **Credential/key management:** Encryption keys and secrets are managed exclusively through the approved **Nexus Key Management Service (KMS)**; hardcoding credentials in source code or config files is strictly prohibited and enforced via automated code-scanning in CI/CD pipelines.
 - **Email encryption:** Emails containing Tier 3/4 data should use encrypted transmission options within NexusMail or be shared via secure NexusDocs links rather than plaintext attachments.
 - Employees must never disable or circumvent encryption settings on company devices or cloud storage configurations.
-

10. Remote Access

- Remote access to internal Nexus systems must follow the **VPN Usage** requirements defined in **IT Policy, Section 5**.
 - Remote-First and hybrid employees (per Company Profile Working Model) accessing systems from home or while traveling must:
 - Use only Nexus-managed, NDM-enrolled devices
 - Connect via NexusSecure VPN when accessing internal resources
 - Ensure MFA is active on all sessions
 - Public Wi-Fi use requires VPN activation before any Nexus system access — no exceptions (IT Policy §5).
 - Remote access from countries under Nexus's Legal & Compliance travel/data-residency restrictions requires prior approval from IT Security and Legal & Compliance.
 - Split-tunneling, unauthorized remote-access software (e.g., unapproved remote desktop tools), and personal VPN services are prohibited for accessing Nexus systems.
-

11. Incident Reporting

11.1 What Qualifies as an Incident

Includes but is not limited to: suspected phishing compromise, malware infection, lost/stolen device, unauthorized access, data leakage, suspicious account activity, or physical security breaches (e.g., tailgating into an office location).

11.2 Reporting Process

1. **Report immediately** via NexusConnect **#security-incident** channel or the IT Security emergency hotline — do not wait for confirmation that an incident is “serious enough.”
2. **Do not attempt to remediate independently** (e.g., do not try to delete files or “fix” a suspected malware infection) — preserve evidence for IT Security investigation.

3. IT Security triages and classifies incident severity (Low / Medium / High / Critical) within **1 hour** of report during business hours, or **immediately** for Critical/production-impacting issues via the 24/7 on-call rotation.
4. Confirmed incidents involving Tier 4 data or customer data trigger mandatory Legal & Compliance involvement for regulatory assessment (e.g., breach notification obligations).

11.3 Escalation Path

Employee → Manager (informational) → IT Security (actionable report) → Director of Engineering/IT (High/Critical) → CTO + General Counsel (Critical, regulatory, or customer-impacting) → CEO + Board notification (material incidents), consistent with the Approval Hierarchy in the Company Profile.

11.4 Post-Incident

- All Medium+ severity incidents receive a documented post-incident review (blameless retrospective) within 10 business days.
- Findings are logged as a **Nexus Decision Record (NDR)** per Company Profile terminology and shared with relevant Guilds (e.g., Security Guild) where applicable.

12. Security Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
All Employees	Follow this policy, complete annual security training, report suspicious activity promptly
Managers	Ensure team compliance, approve access requests appropriately, escalate concerns
IT & Internal Systems	Maintain endpoint security, NDM enrollment, VPN, MFA infrastructure, incident triage
Information Security Analysts	Monitor threats, run phishing simulations, lead incident investigations
Legal & Compliance	Regulatory compliance, breach notification obligations, DPA/contract review
Directors/VPs	Own data classification decisions within their function, quarterly access reviews
CTO	Overall accountability for technical security posture and incident response
CHRO	Ensures security training compliance and addresses HR aspects of incidents (e.g., insider threat)
CEO/Board	Notified of material/critical incidents; ultimate accountability for organizational risk

13. FAQ

Q: How do I know what classification tier a document falls under? A: If unlabeled, treat it as **Tier 3 — Confidential** by default. Check with the data owner (typically a Director) if uncertain, especially before external sharing.

Q: Can I forward a customer's data to a personal email to work on it over the weekend? A: No. Customer data (Tier 4) must remain within Nexus-approved systems at all times, per Section 3 and IT Policy §10. This applies regardless of intent.

Q: I plugged in a USB drive and got blocked — why? A: All USB devices are automatically scanned, and personal/unknown-origin drives are blocked by default per Section 8. Request an approved encrypted USB drive from IT if you have a legitimate business need.

Q: What's the difference between reporting through IT Policy channels vs. Security Incident channels? A: Routine IT issues (software requests, device problems) go through NexusBoard IT Request. Suspected security incidents (phishing, malware, unauthorized access, lost devices with data exposure) go through **NexusConnect #security-incident** or the emergency hotline for faster triage.

Q: Do I need to report a phishing email even if I didn't click anything? A: Yes — reporting non-clicked phishing attempts helps IT Security block similar attacks organization-wide and is not treated as a failure.

Q: I'm traveling internationally for work — do I need special approval to access Nexus systems? A: If traveling to a country under Legal & Compliance travel/data-residency restrictions, yes — obtain prior approval from IT Security and Legal & Compliance before departure.

Q: Who decides if an incident is "big enough" to escalate to the CEO or Board? A: IT Security and the CTO/General Counsel make that determination based on severity classification (Section 11.2) and the Approval Hierarchy; individual employees should always report upward rather than self-assess severity.

Q: Can I use an AI tool to summarize a confidential internal document? A: Only if the tool is on the Nexus-Approved AI Tools List (see **IT Policy, Section 7**). Confidential (Tier 3) and Restricted (Tier 4) data must never be entered into unapproved or public AI tools.

This Information Security Policy works in conjunction with the Nexus Technologies IT Policy and Company Profile. It is maintained by IT & Internal Systems and Legal & Compliance and is subject to periodic review, particularly as regulatory requirements evolve. Future related documents may include the Data Privacy Policy and Acceptable Use Policy.

Nexus Technologies, Inc. — Finance & Expense Policy

Document type: Company Policy **Owner:** Chief Financial Officer (CFO) / Finance & Accounting Department **Applies to:** All full-time employees, contractors, and approved contingent workers **Effective date:** January 1, 2026 **Review cadence:** Annually, each January, or upon material organizational change **Foundational reference:** This policy is built on and must remain consistent with the *Nexus Technologies Company Profile* (Sections 5, 8, and 9 — Organizational Structure, Reporting Hierarchy, and Approval Hierarchy).

1. Purpose & Scope

This policy governs how employees incur, submit, approve, and get reimbursed for business expenses, and how the company procures goods and services from vendors. It applies globally; regional variations (currency, tax documentation, per diem rates) are maintained as addenda by local Finance leads in Austin, Lisbon, and Bengaluru.

All expense, travel, and purchasing activity is administered through **Workday** (expense reporting, procurement requests, vendor master data) and the **NexusTravel Portal** (travel booking), both owned by Finance & Accounting.

2. Expense Reimbursement

2.1 Eligible Expenses

- Client meals, business meals with colleagues (max 1x/week per team unless traveling)
- Ground transportation, parking, tolls for business purposes
- Business travel costs not covered by corporate card (see Section 3)
- Professional development: conferences, certifications, courses (requires Manager pre-approval)
- Mileage for personal vehicle use on company business

2.2 Non-Reimbursable Expenses

- Personal entertainment, in-room movies, spa services
- Traffic or parking fines, toll violations
- Airline seat upgrades beyond policy class (Section 3.2)
- Spouse, partner, or family travel costs
- Personal subscriptions or software not approved by IT
- Alcohol outside reasonable client entertainment (see FAQ)

2.3 Receipts & Documentation

- Itemized receipts are **required for any expense over \$25 USD**.
- Credit card statements alone are not sufficient documentation — the itemized receipt is required.
- Missing-receipt affidavits are permitted no more than twice per employee per fiscal year.

2.4 Submission Deadlines

- Expenses must be submitted in Workday within **30 calendar days** of being incurred.

- Expenses submitted more than **90 days** after the date incurred require Director approval and may be denied at Finance’s discretion.

2.4a Expense Reimbursement Approval

Per Company Profile §9.3: expense reports **under \$500** route to the Direct Manager only; expense reports **above \$500** additionally route to Finance for validation before disbursement (see §9.1 Approval Workflow).

2.5 Reimbursement Timeline

- Approved expense reports are disbursed via direct deposit within **5-7 business days** of final approval.
- Mileage is reimbursed at the current IRS standard mileage rate, updated each January 1 and posted on NexusHub.

3. Business Travel

3.1 Booking

- All travel must be booked through the **NexusTravel Portal**, which auto-applies cost-center coding and negotiated corporate rates.
- Booking outside the portal requires advance Manager approval and may be reimbursed only up to the portal’s equivalent fare/rate.
- Flights should be booked at least **14 days in advance** where the trip is known that far ahead.

3.2 Airfare Class Policy

Nexus Level	Domestic	International (flight > 6 hrs)
L1-L4 (IC/Manager)	Economy	Economy / Premium Economy
L5-L6 (Staff-Director)	Economy	Premium Economy
L7 / ELT	Economy or Premium Economy	Business

3.3 Hotel Guidelines

City Tier	Example Cities	Nightly Cap
Tier 1	Austin, San Francisco, New York, Dublin, London, Singapore	\$350
Tier 2	All other cities	\$250

Exceptions (e.g., conference host hotels) require Director approval in advance.

3.4 Ground Transportation & Meals

- Ride-share, taxi, and rental car are reimbursable at coach/economy tier.
- Meal per diem: **\$75/day domestic, \$100/day international** (itemized receipts still encouraged but not required under per diem).

3.5 International & High-Risk Travel

- All international travel requires **Director approval**, regardless of cost.
 - Travel to destinations flagged as elevated-risk requires notification to **IT & Security (GRC team)** at least 5 business days prior to departure.
 - Company-booked travel includes automatic travel insurance coverage.
-

4. Corporate Credit Cards

4.1 Eligibility

Cards are issued to employees at **L3 and above**, or to any employee with recurring business expense needs (e.g., Sales, Customer Success, Procurement), upon Manager and Finance approval.

4.2 Monthly Limits

Level	Monthly Limit
L1-L3	\$2,500
L4-L5	\$5,000
Director / VP	\$10,000
ELT	\$25,000

Virtual, single-use cards are available through Procurement for one-off vendor purchases without a standing card.

4.3 Reconciliation

- Cardholders must code and attach receipts to every transaction in Workday within **5 business days** of the statement closing.
- Managers must approve reconciled statements within 3 business days of submission.

4.4 Lost, Stolen, or Compromised Cards

- Report immediately to **Finance & Accounting** and **IT & Security**.
- The card will be frozen within 1 business day and a replacement issued.

4.5 Prohibited Uses

Cash advances, personal purchases, personal gift cards, and any purchase outside approved business categories are prohibited. Repeated late reconciliation or misuse may result in card suspension and, for material or repeated violations, escalation to HR.

5. Purchase Requests

5.1 When a Purchase Request (PR) Is Required

Any purchase not made via corporate card — software subscriptions, hardware, contracted services, recurring vendor spend — requires a **Procurement Request Form (PRF)** submitted in Workday **before** the purchase is made.

5.2 Required Documentation

- Business justification
- Vendor quote or invoice
- Cost center / department code
- Confirmation of available budget (from budget owner — see Section 6)

5.3 Review SLA

- Standard PRs: reviewed within **3 business days**.
- Expedited PRs (requires VP sign-off to invoke): reviewed within **1 business day**.

5.4 Approval Routing

PRs route automatically based on total contract/purchase value, per the thresholds in Section 8 (Procurement Approval). Approval must be granted **before** a PO is issued or payment is committed.

6. Budget Limits

6.1 Budget Ownership

- Departmental annual operating budgets are approved by the **CFO** and the relevant **department VP** during Q4 annual planning for the following fiscal year.
- **Directors and VPs** own and are accountable for their org's budget lines; Managers submit spend requests against their Director's or VP's approved budget.

6.2 Expense & Purchase Approval Thresholds

(Consistent with Company Profile Section 9.3)

Amount	Required Approver
Up to \$1,000	Direct Manager
\$1,001 – \$10,000	Director
\$10,001 – \$50,000	VP + CFO
\$50,001 – \$250,000	CFO + relevant C-Suite sponsor
Above \$250,000	CFO + CEO

(Every tier above \$10,000 includes the CFO, consistent with Company Profile §9.3.)

6.3 Budget Reviews

- **FP&A** conducts quarterly budget reviews with each department.
- Department heads must present a variance explanation for any line item over/under budget by more than **10%**.

6.4 Unbudgeted / Exception Spend

Spend not in the approved annual budget requires written justification and sign-off **one level above** the standard threshold table (e.g., a \$5,000 unbudgeted item requires Director approval instead of Manager).

7. Vendor Payments

7.1 New Vendor Onboarding

- New vendors must submit a completed **W-9** (US) or **W-8BEN** (international), banking details, and any required compliance documentation.
- Accounts Payable (AP) adds the vendor to the Workday vendor master before any invoice can be paid.

7.2 Payment Terms

- Standard terms: **Net 30** from invoice date, unless a different term is negotiated and documented in the vendor contract.

7.3 Payment Methods

- **ACH** is the preferred method for domestic vendors.
- **Wire transfer** for international vendors.
- **Check** issued only by exception, with Controller approval.

7.4 Invoice Submission & Matching

- Vendors submit invoices referencing the applicable PO number to Accounts Payable.
- All invoices undergo **3-way match** (Purchase Order, Receipt/Confirmation of Delivery, Invoice) before payment is released.
- Discrepancies are routed to Procurement for resolution before payment proceeds.

7.5 Payment Run Cadence

AP processes standard payment runs twice monthly — on the **15th** and the **last business day** of the month.

8. Procurement Approval

8.1 Contract & Vendor Approval Thresholds

(Consistent with Company Profile Section 9.3, extended with additional value bands)

Contract Value	Required Sign-off Chain
Up to \$25,000	Department Director → Legal review
\$25,001 - \$100,000	Department VP → Legal → Finance (Controller)
\$100,001 - \$500,000	ELT sponsor → General Counsel → CFO
Above \$500,000	CEO + CFO + General Counsel

8.2 Competitive Bidding

Purchases above **\$50,000** require a minimum of **two vendor quotes**, unless a sole-source justification is submitted and approved.

8.3 Sole-Source Justification

Requires a written explanation of why only one vendor can meet the need, approved jointly by the requesting **Department VP** and the **Procurement Lead**.

8.4 Preferred Vendors

Procurement maintains a preferred vendor list for recurring spend categories (software, travel, contractors). Use of a non-preferred vendor in these categories requires Procurement sign-off in addition to the standard approval chain.

9. Approval Workflow

9.1 Expense Reimbursement Flow

Employee submits expense report (Workday)
|
Routes to Direct Manager (or higher, per Section 6.2 threshold)
|
Finance validates receipts & coding
|
Accounts Payable disburses via direct deposit

9.2 Purchase Request Flow

Employee submits PRF (Workday) – before purchase
|
Routes per Section 8 thresholds (Director / VP / ELT+Legal / CEO+CF0+GC)
|
Procurement issues Purchase Order
|
Vendor delivers goods/services & invoices
|
AP performs 3-way match
|
Payment released per Section 7 terms

9.3 Corporate Card Flow

Transaction occurs on corporate card
|
Cardholder codes & attaches receipt in Workday (within 5 business days)
|
Manager approves reconciliation (within 3 business days)
|
Finance closes the statement period

9.4 Vendor Contract Flow

Requestor drafts Statement of Work / contract
|
Legal review
|

Approval chain per Section 8.1
|
Procurement issues PO
|
AP applies standard payment terms (Section 7)

10. FAQ

Q: I lost a receipt — can I still get reimbursed? Yes, up to twice per fiscal year using a missing-receipt affidavit in Workday. Beyond that, Manager approval is required on a case-by-case basis.

Q: Can I book travel outside the NexusTravel Portal? Only with advance Manager approval, and reimbursement is capped at what the portal would have cost for an equivalent booking.

Q: How long does reimbursement take once approved? 5–7 business days via direct deposit.

Q: What happens if I exceed my corporate card limit? Transactions will decline. Contact Finance & Accounting to request a temporary limit increase before traveling or making a large purchase — this should be requested at least 3 business days in advance.

Q: Who approves a purchase that wasn't in our department's budget? One level higher than the standard threshold in Section 6.2 — for example, a \$3,000 unbudgeted item needs Director approval instead of Manager approval.

Q: Can I expense alcohol? Reasonable alcohol as part of client entertainment is reimbursable. Alcohol for internal team events should go through your Director for approval rather than individual expense reports.

Q: A vendor's invoice doesn't match our PO — what happens? It's held by Accounts Payable and routed to Procurement for resolution; payment is not released until the 3-way match is resolved.

Q: Who do I contact with questions about this policy? Your local Finance & Accounting business partner, or the #team-finance Slack channel for general questions.

This policy is maintained by Finance & Accounting and reviewed annually. Exceptions to any threshold or process in this document require written CFO approval. This document should be read alongside the Nexus Technologies Company Profile for organizational and role definitions.

Nexus Technologies — Legal & Compliance Manual

Document type: Legal & Compliance Manual (Company-Wide Policy of Record)
Owner: Legal & Compliance Department — led by General Counsel, reporting to the CEO (Company Profile §6) **Data privacy owner:** Data Protection Officer (DPO), within Legal & Compliance **Approved by:** Executive Leadership Team (ELT); security-related sections jointly with the CISO (Company Profile §9.4) **Applies to:** Nexus Technologies, Inc. and all wholly owned subsidiaries (US, Portugal, India)
Classification: Internal — All Employees **Version:** 1.0 — July 2026 **Review cycle:** Annual, or earlier on material legal/regulatory change

Related documents

- **Company Profile** — canonical source for structure, roles, hierarchy, offices, approval thresholds, and terminology. All defined terms (ELT, DRI, CISO, CHRO, NexusFlow, etc.) carry the meaning given there.
- **HR Policy Manual** — governs the employment relationship. **Cross-referenced throughout** wherever legal obligations attach to people (Code of Conduct, confidentiality, IP assignment, onboarding/offboarding access, training, reporting, and non-retaliation).
- **Remote Work Policy** — governs remote/hybrid mechanics, including home-office security and device handling referenced in the confidentiality and data-privacy sections.
- **Security (InfoSec) Standards** — owned by the CISO; governs the technical controls that operationalize the confidentiality, privacy, and regulatory requirements below.
- **Regional / Local Addenda** — jurisdiction-specific supplements. **Where a local addendum or applicable law requires a different or stricter standard, that requirement governs for that jurisdiction.**

Boundary note — Legal vs. Security

This manual sets the **legal and policy** requirements. The **CISO / InfoSec** team owns the **technical controls** that implement them (access management, encryption, monitoring, incident response tooling). Where this manual says “protected” or “secured,” the specific control is defined in the Security Standards. Legal and Security co-own privacy incident response.

1. Purpose & Scope

1.1 Purpose

This manual establishes how Nexus Technologies meets its legal, contractual, ethical, and regulatory obligations. It exists to:

- Protect Nexus, its customers, and its people by setting clear, consistent rules for confidentiality, intellectual property, contracting, privacy, and compliance.
- Translate the Core Values — especially **Integrity**, **Ownership**, and **Clarity** — into enforceable legal practice.
- Give employees a single reference for what the law and Nexus require of them, and where to go when unsure.

Consistent with **clarity over cleverness**, this manual is written to be understood by non-lawyers. When a situation is genuinely ambiguous, the rule is simple: **ask Legal & Compliance before acting.**

1.2 Scope

This manual applies to **all employees, interns, and fixed-term staff** across every office and remote arrangement, and — for the obligations that extend to them — to **contractors, vendors, and partners** who handle Nexus or customer information. The employment-category definitions in the HR Policy Manual (§3) determine who falls into each group.

This manual is not legal advice for any specific situation and does not replace advice from Legal & Compliance or qualified local counsel.

2. Non-Disclosure Agreements (NDAs)

An NDA is the baseline legal instrument protecting confidential information exchanged with, or by, Nexus.

2.1 When an NDA is required

An approved NDA must be in place **before** confidential information is shared, in situations including:

- Sales and partnership discussions where either party will disclose non-public information.
- Vendor and supplier engagements involving access to Nexus systems or data.
- Evaluations, proofs of concept, and pilots of NexusFlow with a prospective customer.
- Any exchange with an external party where non-public technical, product, financial, or customer information will be shared.

2.2 Types of NDA

Type	Use
Employee confidentiality obligation	Built into every employment agreement — not a separate NDA per engagement. See §4 (Confidential Information) and HR Policy §11.3.
Mutual NDA	Both parties will disclose confidential information (most common with customers and partners).
One-way NDA	Only one party discloses (e.g., a vendor receiving Nexus information).
Vendor / contractor NDA	Signed by third parties before they access Nexus systems or data, in addition to their commercial agreement.

2.3 Standard terms and approval

- Nexus maintains **approved NDA templates** owned by Legal & Compliance. Using the standard template with no material edits is the fast path.
- **Standard NDA (unmodified template):** may be approved and executed by the deal or engagement owner (e.g., an Account Executive or engagement DRI) per their delegated authority.

- **Non-standard NDA** (counterparty's paper, or material edits — e.g., unusual term length, broad indemnities, governing-law changes): must be reviewed and approved by **Legal & Compliance** before signature.
- NDAs are **records** and are stored in Legal's contract repository (§9.5 principles for signature authority apply).

2.4 Duration and survival

- Confidentiality obligations typically survive for a defined period after the relationship ends (commonly several years), and **indefinitely for trade secrets**, per the specific agreement.
 - Employee confidentiality obligations **survive termination of employment**, as reinforced in HR Policy §17.3.
-

3. Intellectual Property (IP)

Nexus's intellectual property — its platform, code, connectors, designs, brand, and know-how — is among its most valuable assets. Protecting it is everyone's responsibility.

3.1 Ownership of work product

- Work created by employees within the scope of their employment — code, designs, documentation, inventions, and other work product — is **owned by Nexus**. This assignment is established in the **employment agreement** each employee signs (see HR Policy §16.1 onboarding and §11 conduct).
- Contractors and agencies assign relevant IP to Nexus through their engagement contracts; **no external work is accepted without a valid IP-assignment clause** vetted by Legal.

3.2 Inventions and patents

- Employees must **promptly disclose** potentially patentable inventions to Legal & Compliance via the invention-disclosure process.
- Nexus decides whether to pursue patent protection. Employees cooperate with filings, including after they leave, per their agreement.

3.3 Open-source software

- Nexus both uses and, in defined cases, contributes to open-source software. Because open-source licenses carry obligations that can affect the proprietary platform, **all open-source use and contribution follows the Open-Source Software standard** co-owned by Engineering and Legal.
- Incoming open-source components must be license-cleared before inclusion in Nexus-Flow. Copyleft/reciprocal licenses (e.g., strong copyleft) require Legal review before use in distributed or hosted code.
- Employees may not contribute Nexus code to external open-source projects without approval.

3.4 Third-party IP

- Employees must not import third-party code, content, designs, or copyrighted material into Nexus products or materials without a valid license or permission.

- Respecting others' IP is part of the Code of Ethics (§6) and fair-dealing obligations.

3.5 Trademarks and brand

- **Nexus Technologies** and **NexusFlow** are brand assets. Use of Nexus names, logos, and marks follows brand-usage guidance; external use by partners requires approval.
- Employees must not register domains, handles, or marks incorporating Nexus branding on the company's behalf without Legal approval.

4. Confidential Information

4.1 Data classification

Nexus classifies information into four tiers. Every employee is responsible for handling information according to its classification. The **technical controls** for each tier are defined in the Security Standards (CISO).

Tier	Definition	Examples
Public	Approved for public release.	Marketing content, published docs, press releases.
Internal	Default for internal business information; not for external release.	Internal plans, most Confluence pages, org information.
Confidential	Sensitive information whose disclosure could harm Nexus, customers, or individuals.	Non-public financials, product roadmaps, contracts, source code.
Restricted	Highest sensitivity; strict need-to-know.	Customer personal data, security keys/credentials, regulated data, M&A materials.

4.2 Handling obligations

- Access is on a **need-to-know / least-privilege** basis (implemented by IT and Security).
- Confidential and Restricted information must not be shared externally without an NDA (§2) and a legitimate business reason.
- **Customer data** processed on the platform is treated as Restricted and handled under the Data Privacy section (§7) and customer contracts (DPAs).
- Do not discuss Confidential/Restricted matters in public spaces, and do not post them in unsanctioned tools. Use only the sanctioned tool stack (Company Profile §12).

4.3 Confidentiality and remote work

- Confidentiality obligations apply **identically** in the office and remotely. Remote employees must protect screens, conversations, printed materials, and devices from household or public exposure. The specific home-office security requirements are set in the **Remote Work Policy** and Security Standards, and reinforced in HR Policy §11.3.

4.4 Duration

- Confidentiality obligations **continue after employment or engagement ends** (HR Policy §17.3). Departing employees must return or destroy confidential materials as part of offboarding (§8 record disposal; HR Policy §17.3).

5. Contract Approval

No one may bind Nexus to a contract without authority. This section defines **who can approve and sign what**, consistent with the approval hierarchy in the Company Profile (§9).

5.1 Core principles

- **Only authorized signatories** may execute contracts on behalf of Nexus. Approval authority does not equal signature authority — both must be satisfied.
- **No self-approval.** The person requesting a contract cannot be its sole approver (Company Profile §9 approval principle).
- **Standard templates are the fast path.** Nexus’s approved templates (NDAs, order forms, DPAs, vendor terms) route faster than counterparty paper or custom terms.
- **Legal reviews non-standard terms.** Any deviation from approved templates — unusual liability, indemnity, IP, data, or governing-law terms — requires Legal & Compliance review before signature.

5.2 Commercial (customer) contract approval

Mapped to the Company Profile commercial approval thresholds (§9.5):

Situation	Approval required
Standard contract at list pricing	Account Executive + Sales Manager
Discount up to 15%	Sales Manager
Discount 15-30%	Regional Sales Director
Discount above 30% or non-standard commercial terms	VP of Sales + CFO
Non-standard legal terms (liability, IP, data, indemnity)	Legal & Compliance (in addition to commercial approvals)
Enterprise deal above \$1M ARR	CRO + CEO

5.3 Procurement (vendor) contract approval

Vendor spend follows the spending thresholds in the Company Profile (§9.1) — Manager → Director → VP → C-suite → CFO/CEO by amount — **plus** Legal review of the contract terms, and Security review where the vendor will access Nexus systems or data.

5.4 Document and policy sign-off

Per Company Profile §9.4:

- **Customer-facing legal / contract terms:** Legal + CFO (or CRO for commercial terms).
- **Security / compliance policy:** CISO + Legal.
- **Company-wide policy (including this manual):** Executive Leadership Team.

5.5 Workflow

1. **Initiate** — the deal or engagement DRI selects the correct template.
 2. **Review** — Legal reviews non-standard terms; Security and the DPO review data/security terms where applicable (§7).
 3. **Approve** — the required approvers per §5.2–5.4 sign off.
 4. **Execute** — an authorized signatory signs.
 5. **Store** — the fully executed contract is filed in Legal’s contract repository as a retained record (§8). Commercial records are also tracked in Salesforce, the company’s CRM system.
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6. Code of Ethics

This section states Nexus’s ethical standard. It builds on — and shares a single source of truth with — the **Code of Business Conduct & Ethics** summarized in HR Policy §11. Where the two are read together, they must not conflict; this manual owns the legal detail, the HR manual owns the employment framing.

6.1 Ethical foundations

Ethics at Nexus flow from the Core Values, especially **integrity, honesty, and owning the outcome**. Every employee, contractor, and intern is bound by them.

6.2 Core ethical obligations

Area	Standard
Conflicts of interest	Disclose any personal, financial, or family interest that could conflict with your role. When in doubt, disclose to your manager or Legal.
Gifts & hospitality	Never give or accept gifts, entertainment, or hospitality intended to improperly influence a decision. Modest, customary business courtesy is acceptable within the gifts standard.
Anti-bribery & corruption	Zero tolerance for bribes, kickbacks, or facilitation payments, directly or through third parties — consistent with anti-corruption laws (e.g., US FCPA, UK Bribery Act) across all jurisdictions where Nexus operates.
Fair dealing & competition	Compete honestly. Do not misrepresent Nexus’s products or a competitor’s, and comply with competition/antitrust law.
Insider information	Do not trade on, or share, material non-public information about Nexus (as a private company) or about customers/partners.

Area	Standard
Accurate records	Keep truthful business, financial, and evaluation records. Never falsify data — including demo, benchmark, or evaluation results presented to customers.
Respect for IP and privacy	Respect the IP and personal data of others (\$3, \$7).
Sanctions & trade	Do not transact with sanctioned parties or in violation of export controls (\$10).

6.3 Raising concerns and non-retaliation

- Ethics or legal concerns can be raised with a manager, Legal & Compliance, or through the **confidential reporting channel** (shared with the HR reporting channels in HR Policy §11.4 and §13.4).
- **Retaliation is prohibited** against anyone who reports a concern in good faith or cooperates with an investigation — reinforcing HR Policy §13.4.
- Good-faith reporting is expected: staying silent about a known violation is itself a breach of the Code.

7. Data Privacy

Nexus handles personal data both as an employer and as a technology provider whose platform processes customer data. This section governs how that data is protected. The **DPO**, within Legal & Compliance, owns privacy; the **CISO** owns the security controls that protect the data.

7.1 Nexus's two privacy roles

Role	When it applies	Example
Controller	Nexus decides why/how personal data is used.	Employee HR data, job applicants, marketing prospects, website visitors.
Processor	Nexus processes personal data on behalf of a customer under their instructions.	Personal data flowing through a customer's Flows and connectors on NexusFlow.

This distinction matters: as a **processor**, Nexus acts only on documented customer instructions under a **Data Processing Agreement (DPA)**, and does not use customer personal data for its own purposes.

7.2 Privacy principles

Nexus applies globally consistent principles, tightened by local law:

- **Lawfulness, fairness, transparency** — process personal data with a valid basis and clear notice.

- **Purpose limitation & data minimization** — collect only what is needed, for stated purposes.
- **Accuracy & storage limitation** — keep data accurate and retain it only as long as needed (see §8).
- **Security** — protect personal data with appropriate technical and organizational controls (Security Standards).
- **Accountability** — be able to demonstrate compliance.
- **Privacy & security by design** — build privacy into products and processes from the start; the Data & AI and Product teams engage the DPO for features touching personal data.

7.3 Data subject rights

- Individuals may have rights to access, correct, delete, restrict, or port their personal data, and to object to certain processing, depending on jurisdiction.
- **Controller requests** (e.g., from employees or prospects) are handled by the DPO within legal timeframes.
- **Processor requests** (from a customer's end users) are **forwarded to the customer**, who is the controller; Nexus assists per the DPA.

7.4 International data transfers

- Nexus operates across the Americas, EMEA, and APAC (Company Profile §10). Cross-border transfers of personal data use an approved legal transfer mechanism (e.g., standard contractual clauses or equivalent) and are reviewed by the DPO.

7.5 Personal data breach response

- Any suspected exposure of personal data must be reported **immediately** to Security and the DPO through the incident process (Company Profile §12 incident channels).
- **Legal and Security co-own** privacy incident response: containment (Security), legal assessment and any regulatory/customer notification within required deadlines (DPO/Legal).
- As a **processor**, Nexus notifies affected **customers** without undue delay so they can meet their own obligations.

7.6 Employee and candidate privacy

- Employee and applicant personal data (held in Workday and recruiting systems) is processed as controller, per the privacy notice and HR Policy. Access is need-to-know and retained per §8.

8. Record Retention

Nexus keeps records long enough to meet legal, tax, contractual, and operational needs — and disposes of them securely when that need ends. Keeping data forever creates risk; deleting too early breaks obligations.

8.1 Principles

- Every record has an **owner** and a **retention period** defined by a **Retention Schedule** maintained by Legal & Compliance.

- Records are retained in **sanctioned systems** only (Company Profile §12), never in un-managed personal storage.
- When the period expires, records are **securely disposed of** unless a legal hold applies.

8.2 Representative retention categories

The schedule is authoritative; the table illustrates the approach. Actual periods are set per category and jurisdiction (Regional Addenda may extend them).

Record type	Illustrative retention approach
Executed contracts & NDAs	Retained for the life of the agreement plus a defined period after termination.
Financial & tax records	Retained for the period required by tax and accounting law in each jurisdiction.
Employee records	Retained during employment and for a defined period after departure (coordinated with HR Policy §17).
Recruitment records	Retained for a limited period after a hiring decision.
Customer personal data (processor)	Retained and deleted per the customer's instructions and DPA.
Security & audit logs	Retained per the Security Standards and applicable regulation.
Marketing/consent records	Retained while consent is valid, then disposed.

8.3 Legal holds

- When litigation, an investigation, or a regulatory request is reasonably anticipated, Legal issues a **legal hold** that **suspends normal disposal** for the affected records.
- Employees who receive a legal hold notice must preserve the specified records and must not delete or alter them. Legal holds override the standard retention schedule until released by Legal.

8.4 Disposal

- Expired records are disposed of securely (secure deletion or destruction) so they cannot be reconstructed — the technical method is defined by the Security Standards.
- Offboarding disposal of an employee's confidential materials is coordinated with HR Policy §17.3 and IT/Security deprovisioning.

9. Compliance Program

The compliance program is the operating system that keeps the obligations in this manual working in practice.

9.1 Ownership and structure

- **Legal & Compliance** owns the program, with the **DPO** for privacy and the **CISO** for security compliance.

- Executive accountability sits with the **ELT**; the program reports on posture to leadership on a regular cadence (aligned with the QBR rhythm, Company Profile §13.4).

9.2 Training and awareness

- All employees complete **mandatory compliance training**, delivered and tracked through the learning framework in HR Policy §15.2 — including **security-awareness training (CISO)**, **privacy training (DPO)**, anti-harassment (HR), and role-specific training (e.g., anti-bribery for customer-facing and procurement roles).
- New joiners complete required training in their first week (HR Policy §16.2).

9.3 Third-party and vendor compliance

- Vendors and partners are risk-assessed before engagement. Those handling Nexus or customer data sign appropriate NDAs (§2), DPAs (§7), and security terms, and are reviewed by Legal and Security (§5.3).

9.4 Monitoring, reporting, and enforcement

- The confidential reporting channel (§6.3, HR Policy §11.4) lets anyone raise a concern without retaliation.
 - Reported issues are investigated fairly and consistently; substantiated violations may lead to disciplinary action up to termination (through the HR process, HR Policy §9.5/§17) and, where relevant, legal or regulatory action.
 - Compliance failures are treated as learning inputs, not just penalties — consistent with **own the outcome**.
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10. Regulatory Compliance

As an enterprise iPaaS serving regulated industries — financial services, healthcare, retail, logistics, and public sector (Company Profile §1) — Nexus operates within a broad regulatory landscape. This section frames the main areas; specifics live with the responsible owners.

10.1 Security and trust certifications

- Nexus maintains an information-security program aligned to recognized frameworks (e.g., **SOC 2 Type II** and **ISO/IEC 27001**), owned by the CISO with Legal support. Certifications and attestations are provided to customers through the standard trust/security review process rather than ad hoc.

10.2 Data protection regulations

- Because Nexus operates across multiple regions, its privacy program (§7) is built to satisfy applicable regimes in the jurisdictions where it operates and where customers are based — including, without limitation, the EU/UK GDPR (via the London/EMEA operations), US state privacy laws (e.g., California), Canada’s PIPEDA, Singapore’s PDPA, India’s data-protection law, and Jordan’s personal-data-protection requirements. The DPO maintains the mapping; Regional Addenda carry the detail.

10.3 Industry-specific obligations

- **Healthcare customers:** where Nexus processes protected health information on a customer's behalf, it acts as a **processor/business associate** under the appropriate agreement and controls (e.g., HIPAA-aligned terms in the US), rather than assuming those obligations independently.
- **Financial-services customers:** Nexus supports customers' own regulatory needs through security, auditability, and contractual commitments, without itself becoming a regulated financial institution.
- **Public-sector customers:** additional procurement, security, and data-residency terms may apply and are handled with Legal.

10.4 Export controls and sanctions

- Nexus complies with applicable export-control and economic-sanctions laws. Employees must not provide the platform, technology, or services to sanctioned parties or embargoed destinations. Questions route to Legal (§6.2).

10.5 Responsible AI

- Nexus's **Data & AI** team (Company Profile §6) builds AI/ML features (e.g., workflow suggestions). These follow a **responsible-AI standard** co-owned by Data & AI, Legal, and Security: transparency about AI-generated output, appropriate handling of training and customer data (§7), and human oversight. This extends the AI-ethics principle already reflected in the team's engineering norms.

10.6 Accessibility and employment law

- Nexus works toward accessibility standards for its products and workplace.
- Employment-law compliance across the six jurisdictions is handled jointly by Legal and People (HR) through the **Regional Addenda** referenced in the HR Policy Manual (§2).

11. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q1. Someone wants to see our product before signing anything — do we need an NDA first? Yes. If non-public information will be shared, an approved NDA must be in place first. A standard mutual NDA is the fast path; counterparty paper or edited terms go to Legal (§2).

Q2. I built something useful on the side that relates to my work. Who owns it? Work created within the scope of your employment is owned by Nexus under your employment agreement. If you think something falls outside that scope, disclose it to Legal rather than assuming (§3.1).

Q3. Can I add an open-source library to our codebase? Only after it's license-cleared under the Open-Source Software standard. Some licenses create obligations that affect our proprietary platform, so certain licenses need Legal review before use (§3.3).

Q4. How do I know how sensitive a document is? Use the four-tier classification: Public, Internal, Confidential, Restricted. Customer personal data and credentials are Restricted and need-to-know (§4.1).

Q5. A customer sent us their own contract instead of our template. Can I just sign it? No. Counterparty paper and any non-standard legal terms require Legal review, and only an

authorized signatory can execute it — after the right approvals for the deal size and discount (§5).

Q6. Can I accept a gift from a vendor or customer? Modest, customary business courtesy is fine. Anything that could look like it's meant to influence a decision is not. When unsure, disclose to your manager or Legal (§6.2).

Q7. I think I saw personal data exposed. What do I do? Report it immediately to Security and the DPO through the incident process — do not wait to be certain. Legal and Security handle assessment and any required notifications (§7.5).

Q8. A customer's user asked us to delete their data. Do we? If it relates to data we process on a customer's behalf, we forward the request to that customer (the controller) and assist per the DPA — we don't act on it unilaterally (§7.3).

Q9. Can I delete old files to clean up? Follow the Retention Schedule. And if you've received a **legal hold** covering those records, you must preserve them — legal holds override normal deletion (§8.3).

Q10. How does this manual relate to the HR manual? They're designed to work together. The HR Policy Manual owns the employment framing (conduct, confidentiality obligations, reporting, discipline); this manual owns the legal and regulatory detail. Where they touch — the Code of Ethics, confidentiality, IP assignment, training, offboarding — they cross-reference each other and must stay consistent.

Q11. I'm not sure whether something is allowed. What's the safe move? Ask Legal & Compliance before acting. "I asked first" is always better than "I assumed." (§1.1)

Q12. Do these rules apply when I work from home? Yes — identically. Confidentiality and privacy obligations don't change location. The specific home-office security and device requirements are in the Remote Work Policy and Security Standards (§4.3).

This Legal & Compliance Manual is a company-wide policy of record, aligned to the Nexus Technologies Company Profile and intended to be read alongside the HR Policy Manual, the Remote Work Policy, the Security Standards, and applicable Regional Addenda. It is reviewed annually and updated as Nexus's legal and regulatory obligations evolve. When in doubt, ask Legal & Compliance before acting.

Nexus Technologies — General Company Policies

Foundation Reference: Nexus Technologies Company Profile Document Owner: People & Culture (HR), in coordination with IT, Finance, Legal & Compliance, and Security Applies to: All full-time, part-time, and contract employees globally

1. Remote Work Policy

Applicability: Employees designated as “Remote-First” per the Company Profile’s Working Model.

1.1 Remote-first employees must maintain a stable internet connection sufficient for **Nexus-Meet** video conferencing and **NexusConnect** availability during their designated Core Hours (10:00 AM – 3:00 PM local time).

1.2 Employees must attend the quarterly **Nexus Sync** in-person gathering at their nearest regional office unless excused by their Direct Manager and HR.

1.3 Home office equipment (laptop, monitor, peripherals) is provisioned through **IT Policy** procurement workflows; requests are submitted via the NexusHR Portal and routed to IT for fulfillment.

1.4 Remote employees are responsible for securing their home network in accordance with **Security Policy** minimum standards (see Security Policy §Endpoint & Network Security). Use of public/unsecured Wi-Fi for company work is prohibited without an active VPN connection.

1.5 Time-zone overlap with the employee’s Pod or department must be maintained for at least the Core Hours window; exceptions require Program Manager and Direct Manager sign-off.

1.6 All remote work expenses (internet stipend, equipment) follow the reimbursement thresholds defined in the **Finance Policy / Approval Hierarchy**.

2. Hybrid Work Policy

Applicability: Employees designated as “Hybrid” per the Company Profile.

2.1 Hybrid employees are required in-office on **Core Collaboration Days (Tuesday-Thursday)** at their assigned office location, unless otherwise approved by their Direct Manager.

2.2 Monday and Friday are flexible remote days by default; teams may adjust this locally with Director approval, provided Core Collaboration Days remain fixed.

2.3 Office access (badge, desk booking) is managed through Operations; lost badges or access issues are reported to IT Support per **IT Policy** procedures.

2.4 Hybrid employees relocating outside a reasonable commuting distance of their assigned office must notify HR and their Manager in advance; continued hybrid status is not guaranteed and may convert to Remote-First pending role and business needs.

2.5 In-office conduct (desk hoteling, shared space etiquette, meeting room booking) follows Operations’ facilities guidelines, referenced separately.

3. Company Communication Guidelines

3.1 **Tool-to-purpose mapping** (per Company Profile §12): - **NexusConnect** — day-to-day, informal, channel-based team communication. - **NexusMail** — formal, external, or documentation-required communication (contracts, client correspondence, official notices). - **NexusDocs** — persistent documentation, decisions, and knowledge base entries. - **The Signal** — official company-wide announcements from Executive leadership only; employees may not use this channel for department-level announcements.

3.2 Employees must respond to NexusConnect messages during Core Hours within a reasonable timeframe (target: same business day for non-urgent items).

3.3 Confidential, financial, HR, or legal matters must **never** be discussed in open NexusConnect channels; use private channels or NexusMail with appropriate distribution restrictions per **Security Policy** data classification rules.

3.4 External communications (press, public statements, social media on behalf of Nexus) require approval per the Approval Hierarchy (Marketing Director → CMO → CEO if material).

3.5 All company-wide written communication must reflect the Core Values (Clarity, Integrity, Ownership, Curiosity, Momentum) in tone and content.

4. Meeting Policy

4.1 Meetings should default to **NexusMeet** and be scheduled within Core Hours (10:00 AM – 3:00 PM local) to accommodate hybrid, remote, and cross-region attendees.

4.2 Every meeting invite must include a stated purpose and, where applicable, a NexusDocs agenda link.

4.3 **No-Meeting Guidance:** Recurring meetings without a documented agenda for two consecutive occurrences should be canceled or converted to an async NexusConnect/NexusDocs update.

4.4 Pod meetings (cross-functional) are coordinated by the Program Manager; department meetings are coordinated by the respective Director/VP.

4.5 Meeting recordings (via NexusMeet) containing confidential or client information must be stored and access-controlled per **Security Policy** data retention and access rules.

4.6 Large all-hands meetings are scheduled and communicated via **The Signal**.

5. Employee Responsibilities

5.1 Employees are responsible for understanding and adhering to all policies referenced in this document, including detailed **HR Policy**, **IT Policy**, **Finance Policy**, and **Security Policy** documents.

5.2 Employees must complete all mandatory training (security awareness, compliance, code of conduct) assigned via the NexusHR Portal within specified deadlines.

5.3 Employees must promptly report policy violations, safety concerns, or ethical concerns to their Manager, HR Business Partner, or through the confidential channel described in the Ethics section (§8).

5.4 Employees are accountable for the accuracy of time, expense, and PTO submissions per **Finance Policy** and **HR Policy** procedures.

5.5 Employees must safeguard company assets (devices, credentials, intellectual property) per **Security Policy** and **IT Policy** standards, and report lost/stolen equipment to IT Security immediately.

6. Workplace Expectations

6.1 All employees are expected to demonstrate professionalism and mutual respect in every interaction, in person, hybrid, or remote — consistent with the Nexus Way.

6.2 Harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind is strictly prohibited. Reporting mechanisms and investigation procedures are detailed in the **HR Policy** (Anti-Harassment & Non-Discrimination section).

6.3 Dress code is “role-appropriate”: business casual for client-facing roles/meetings, casual otherwise, unless a specific event dictates formal attire.

6.4 Attendance, punctuality, and availability during Core Hours are baseline expectations across all working models.

6.5 Performance is evaluated through the **Beacon Review** annual cycle, supplemented by ongoing Manager feedback; specifics are governed by the **HR Policy**.

7. Use of AI Tools

7.1 Employees may use Nexus-approved AI tools (including internal AI features within Nexus-Flow, NexusDocs, and any Nexus-sanctioned third-party AI assistants) to support productivity, subject to the restrictions below.

7.2 **Data protection:** No confidential client data, unreleased product information, financial data, or personal employee data may be input into any non-approved external AI tool. Approved tools and data-handling boundaries are defined jointly by **Security Policy** and **IT Policy**.

7.3 Employees must not rely on AI-generated output as final work product without human review — particularly for code (Engineering), legal/contractual language (Legal & Compliance), financial figures (Finance), or customer-facing communications (CS/Marketing).

7.4 Use of AI tools for hiring decisions, performance evaluations, or disciplinary actions is prohibited without HR and Legal oversight, to ensure fairness and compliance.

7.5 Any new AI tool requested for department use must go through the IT Security review and approval process before adoption (see **IT Policy** — Software Approval).

7.6 Employees must disclose material use of AI-generated content in client deliverables where contractually or ethically relevant, per **Legal & Compliance** guidance.

8. Ethics

8.1 Employees must act with integrity in all business dealings, avoiding conflicts of interest, bribery, or misuse of company position for personal gain.

8.2 Gifts, hospitality, or incentives from vendors/clients above a nominal value must be disclosed to Legal & Compliance.

8.3 Insider information (financial results, M&A activity, unreleased product features) must never be shared externally or used for personal trading advantage, consistent with **Finance Policy** and Legal & Compliance insider trading rules.

8.4 A confidential **Ethics & Integrity Line** (managed by Legal & Compliance, independent of direct management chains) is available for reporting suspected violations without fear of retaliation.

8.5 Ethics violations are investigated by Legal & Compliance in coordination with HR, and outcomes follow the disciplinary procedures defined in the **HR Policy**.

9. Sustainability

9.1 Nexus commits to reducing its operational carbon footprint through energy-efficient office operations (managed by Operations) and default-remote/hybrid work models that reduce commuting impact.

9.2 Offices are encouraged to minimize single-use materials; procurement of office supplies should favor sustainable vendors where feasible, subject to Finance's vendor approval process.

9.3 Cloud infrastructure decisions (Engineering & IT) should factor in energy-efficient hosting providers and data center regions where technically and financially viable.

9.4 Employees are encouraged to participate in optional annual sustainability initiatives coordinated by Operations and communicated via **The Signal**.

9.5 Business travel (see **Finance Policy** — Travel & Expense) should favor virtual meetings via NexusMeet where practical, reserving travel for high-value client or strategic engagements.

10. Business Continuity

10.1 Each department Director/VP is responsible for maintaining a Business Continuity Plan (BCP) covering critical role coverage, data access, and communication fallback procedures, coordinated by Operations.

10.2 In the event of a regional office disruption (natural disaster, outage, etc.), affected employees default to full remote work status until normal operations resume, communicated via **The Signal** and NexusConnect emergency channels.

10.3 IT maintains disaster recovery and data backup procedures for all critical systems (NexusFlow, NexusDocs, NexusBoard) per **Security Policy** and **IT Policy** standards, including defined Recovery Time Objectives (RTO) and Recovery Point Objectives (RPO).

10.4 Emergency contact trees are maintained by HR through the NexusHR Portal and must be kept current by all employees.

10.5 A cross-functional **Business Continuity Committee**, chaired by the COO with representation from IT, Security, HR, and Facilities, reviews and tests continuity plans at minimum annually.

Policy Cross-Reference Index

This Document Section	Detailed Governing Policy
Remote/Hybrid Work	HR Policy, IT Policy
Communication Guidelines	IT Policy, Security Policy (data classification)
Meeting Policy	IT Policy (tools), Security Policy (recordings)
Employee Responsibilities	HR Policy, IT Policy, Finance Policy, Security Policy
Workplace Expectations	HR Policy (Anti-Harassment, Beacon Review)
Use of AI Tools	IT Policy (Software Approval), Security Policy (data handling)
Ethics	Legal & Compliance, HR Policy (disciplinary procedures)
Sustainability	Finance Policy (Travel & Expense), Operations guidelines
Business Continuity	IT Policy (DR/Backup), Security Policy, Operations BCP

This document serves as the general policy layer for Nexus Technologies. Detailed HR, IT, Finance, and Security Policy documents will elaborate on the specific procedures referenced above and take precedence on matters of implementation detail.

Nexus Technologies — Company FAQ

HR Questions

Q: How many annual leave days do full-time employees receive? A: Full-time employees receive 20 working days for 0-2 completed years of service, 23 working days for 3-5 years, and 25 working days for 6+ years. See HR Policy Manual §5.

Q: How many sick days are available per year? A: Nexus provides up to 10 paid sick days per year, separate from annual leave. See HR Policy Manual §6.

Q: What is the probationary period for new permanent employees? A: New permanent employees serve a probationary period of up to three months, with structured 30-, 60-, and 90-day check-ins. See HR Policy Manual §3.3.

Q: Where are leave requests submitted? A: Leave requests are submitted in Workday and approved by the reporting manager. See HR Policy Manual §5.3.

IT Questions

Q: What is the minimum password length? A: Passwords must be at least 14 characters and include uppercase, lowercase, number, and special character requirements. See IT Policy §3.1.

Q: Is MFA required? A: Yes. MFA is mandatory for NexusMail, NexusConnect, NexusDocs, NexusBoard, NexusFlow, NexusHR Portal, VPN, and production/cloud environments. See IT Policy §4.

Q: When is VPN required? A: Employees must use NexusSecure VPN when connecting to internal Nexus systems from outside an office location. Public Wi-Fi requires VPN before accessing any Nexus system. See IT Policy §5.

Q: Can employees install any software they want? A: No. Unauthorized software requires approval from IT & Internal Systems, and many tools are requested through NexusBoard. See IT Policy §6.

Security Questions

Q: What is the default classification for a new document with no explicit label? A: Tier 3 — Confidential. See Information Security Policy §2.

Q: Can customer data be entered into public AI tools? A: No. Customer data must never be entered into unapproved AI tools. See Information Security Policy §3 and IT Policy §7.

Q: Are personal USB drives allowed? A: Personal or unknown-origin USB drives are prohibited by default on Nexus devices. See Information Security Policy §8.

Q: What should an employee do after clicking a suspected phishing link? A: Disconnect from the network, report to IT Security via the emergency hotline or NexusConnect #security-incident channel, and change affected passwords using NexusVault. See Information Security Policy §6.

Finance Questions

Q: When are itemized receipts required? A: Itemized receipts are required for any expense over \$25 USD. See Finance & Expense Policy §2.3.

Q: How soon must expenses be submitted? A: Expenses must be submitted in Workday within 30 calendar days. Expenses over 90 days old require Director approval and may be denied. See Finance & Expense Policy §2.4.

Q: How long does reimbursement take after approval? A: Approved expense reports are disbursed by direct deposit within 5-7 business days of final approval. See Finance & Expense Policy §2.5.

Q: Who approves a purchase request above \$10,000? A: Purchases above \$10,000 require CFO involvement plus the relevant C-Suite sponsor, consistent with the Company Profile and Finance Policy approval thresholds. See Finance & Expense Policy §6.2 and Company Profile §9.3.

Legal Questions

Q: When is an NDA required? A: An approved NDA is required before confidential information is shared in sales, partnership, vendor, proof-of-concept, or other external engagements involving non-public information. See Legal & Compliance Manual §2.1.

Q: Who owns work created by employees within the scope of employment? A: Nexus owns employee work product created within the scope of employment. See Legal & Compliance Manual §3.1.

Q: Can employees sign contracts on behalf of Nexus? A: Only authorized signatories may execute contracts. Approval authority does not equal signature authority. See Legal & Compliance Manual §5.1.

General Policy Questions

Q: Which days are Core Collaboration Days for hybrid employees? A: Tuesday through Thursday are the standard Core Collaboration Days. See General Company Policies §2 and Company Profile §11.

Q: Which tool should be used for official external business correspondence? A: Nexus-Mail is the official channel for formal or external communications. See General Company Policies §3 and IT Policy §8.

Q: Can employees rely on AI-generated output as final work product? A: No. AI-generated output must receive human review, especially for code, legal, financial, or customer-facing work. See General Company Policies §7.